DISTRICT PANCHAYATH KASARAGOD

EQIP 2026

Educational Quality Improvement Programme for class -X

ENGLISH

Standard -X

QUESTION POOL



DISTRICT INSTITUTE OF EDUCATION AND TRAINING (DIET)
KASARAGOD

EQIP 2025-26

Chief Co-ordinators

Sri. Madhusudhanan T.V.
Deputy Director of Education, Kasaragod
&
Dr. Raghurama Bhat K.
Principal, DIET Kasaragod

Resource Team

Vishwanath Bhat
HST English
MSCHSS Perdala Neerchal

Santhakumari V.
HST English
TIHSS Naimarmoola

Jayasree M.A.
HST English
GHSS Cherkala Central

Praveenkumar N.
HST English
GHSS Maloth Kasaba

Anoop Melath
HST English
GHSS Periye

Academic Co-ordinator

Sri. Gireesh Babu A.
Lecturer, DIET Kasaragod



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ആശംസ

വികേന്ദ്രീകൃത ആസൂത്രണത്തിലൂടെയും നിർവ്വഹണത്തിലൂടെയും കേരളത്തിലെ ആരോഗ്യവിദ്യാഭ്യാസ മേഖലകളെ ദേശീയ തലത്തിൽ ഒന്നാമതെത്തിക്കാൻ നമുക്ക് കഴിഞ്ഞിട്ടുണ്ട്. ഈ നേട്ടങ്ങൾ കൈവരിക്കാൻ പ്രാദേശിക ഭരണകൂടങ്ങൾ സ്തുത്യർ ഹമായ പങ്കുവഹിച്ചു. ദേശീയ സംസ്ഥാനതല പഠനങ്ങൾ നമ്മുടെ കുട്ടികളുടെ പഠന നിലവാരം ഇനിയും ഉയരേണ്ടതുണ്ട് എന്ന സൂചനയാണ് നൽകുന്നത്. പത്താം ക്ലാസിലെ കുട്ടികളുടെ പഠനപ്രശ്നങ്ങൾ പരിഹരിക്കാൻ കഴിഞ്ഞ കുറെ വർഷങ്ങളായി കാസറഗോഡ് ജില്ലാ പഞ്ചായത്തിന്റെ നേതൃത്വത്തിൽ പൊതുവിദ്യാഭ്യാസ വകുപ്പും കാസറഗോഡ് ഡയറ്റും ഒത്തു ചേർന്ന് നടപ്പാക്കുന്ന **'എക്വിപ്പ്' 2025-26 (EQIP 2025-26)** പഠനപരിപോഷണ പരിപാടിക്ക് എല്ലാ പിന്തുണയും ഉറപ്പുതരുന്നു. പൊതുപരീക്ഷകളെ അഭിമുഖീകരിക്കുന്ന പത്താം ക്ലാസിലെ കുട്ടികളുടെ പഠനപ്രവർത്തനങ്ങളുടെ മികവിന്റെ അടയാളമായി മാറുകയാണ് വാർഷിക പരീക്ഷകൾ. അറിവിന്റെ തെളിമയോടെ ഓരോ വിദ്യാർത്ഥിക്കും പരീക്ഷ എഴുതാൻ കഴിയണം. വിദ്യാർത്ഥികളുടെ ജീവിതത്തിലെ ഏറ്റവും പ്രധാനപ്പെട്ട പരീക്ഷകൾക്ക് വേണ്ടി തയ്യാറാക്കിയ ചോദ്യബാങ്കിന് എല്ലാവിധ ആശംസകളും നേരുന്നു. നന്നായി പഠിക്കുക. പരീക്ഷയെ സധൈര്യം നേരിടുക. തളരാതെ മുന്നോട്ട്. വിജയം നിങ്ങളോടൊപ്പമുണ്ട്. ആശംസകൾ.

ശ്രീമതി ബേബി ബാലകൃഷ്ണൻ
ജില്ലാ പഞ്ചായത്ത് പ്രസിഡന്റ്
കാസറഗോഡ്



ആശംസ

കാസറഗോഡ് ജില്ലാ പഞ്ചായത്തിന്റെ നേതൃത്വത്തിൽ ജില്ലയിലെ പൊതുവിദ്യാഭ്യാസ മേഖലയെ ശക്തിപ്പെടുത്തുന്നതിന് നിരവധി പ്രവർത്തനങ്ങളാണ് നടന്നുവരുന്നത്. പൊതുവിദ്യാഭ്യാസ മേഖലയെ പൂർവ്വാധികം കരുത്തോടെ നാം മുന്നോട്ട് നയിക്കുകയാണ്. ഈ ഘട്ടത്തിലാണ് കാസറഗോഡ് ജില്ലാ പഞ്ചായത്തും, പൊതുവിദ്യാഭ്യാസ വകുപ്പും, വിദ്യാഭ്യാസ പരിശീലന കേന്ദ്രവും **(DIET)** പത്താം ക്ലാസ് വിദ്യാർത്ഥികളുടെ പഠന വിടവുകൾ പരിഹരിക്കുന്നതിനും ആത്മവിശ്വാസത്തോടെ പൊതുപരീക്ഷയെ നേരിടാൻ അവരെ പ്രാപ്തരാക്കുന്നതിനും വേണ്ടി പഠനപരിപോഷണ സാമഗ്രി തയ്യാറാക്കിയിട്ടുള്ളത്. ഈ പദ്ധതിയുടെ ഭാഗമായി ആത്യന്തിക വിലയിരുത്തലിനെ അഭിമുഖീകരിക്കാൻ കുട്ടികളെ സഹായിക്കുന്ന തരത്തിൽ വിവിധ വിഷയങ്ങളിൽ വിലയിരുത്തൽ സമീപനത്തിനനുസരിച്ചുള്ള ചോദ്യശേഖരമാണ് **(Question Pool)** ഈ അക്കാദമിക വർഷം തയ്യാറാക്കിയിട്ടുള്ളത്. കുട്ടികളുടെ അക്കാദമിക് മികവ് ഉറപ്പുവരുത്തിക്കൊണ്ട് മികച്ച ഗ്രേഡുകൾ നേടാൻ അവരെ സജ്ജമാക്കാൻ **എക്വിപ് 2025-26 (EQIP 2025-26)** എന്ന പേരിൽ തയ്യാറാക്കിയ ഈ പദ്ധതിക്ക് കഴിയട്ടെയെന്ന് ആശംസിക്കുന്നു.

സ്നേഹപൂർവ്വം

അഡ്വ. സരിത എസ്.എൻ.

ആരോഗ്യ-വിദ്യാഭ്യാസ സ്ഥിരം സമിതി അധ്യക്ഷ,

ജില്ലാ പഞ്ചായത്ത്, കാസറഗോഡ്



ആശംസ

ജില്ലയിലെ അക്കാദമിക പ്രവർത്തനങ്ങളെ ഏകോപിപ്പിച്ച് മുന്നോട്ട് നയിക്കുന്നതിന്റെ പ്രധാന ഉത്തരവാദിത്തം കാസറഗോഡ് ജില്ലാ വിദ്യാഭ്യാസ പരിശീലന കേന്ദ്രത്തിന്റെ (DIET) നേതൃത്വത്തിൽ കാലങ്ങളായി ചെയ്തുവരുന്നുണ്ട്. പ്രീ-പ്രൈമറി തലം മുതൽ ഹയർസെക്കണ്ടറി തലംവരെയുള്ള മേഖലകളിൽ വിവിധങ്ങളായ പദ്ധതികൾ ആസൂത്രണം ചെയ്യാനും നിർവഹിക്കാനും ഡയറ്റിന് ഇതിനകം കഴിഞ്ഞിട്ടുണ്ട്. പത്താം ക്ലാസ്സിലെ കുട്ടികളുടെ പഠനപ്രശ്നങ്ങൾ പരിഹരിക്കാൻ കഴിഞ്ഞ കുറച്ചു വർഷങ്ങളായി ഡയറ്റിന്റെ നേതൃത്വത്തിൽ വിദ്യാഭ്യാസ വകുപ്പ് നടപ്പിലാക്കുന്ന പദ്ധതിയാണ് **എക്വിപ് (Educational Quality Improvement Programme).** അതാതു വർഷത്തെ കുട്ടികളുടെ പഠനപ്രശ്നങ്ങൾ പരിഗണിച്ചുകൊണ്ടാണ് പ്രവർത്തനങ്ങൾ ആസൂത്രണം ചെയ്യുന്നത്. പത്താംതരം പാഠപുസ്തകവും വിലയിരുത്തൽ രീതിയും മാറിയ ഘട്ടത്തിൽ ആണല്ലോ നമ്മൾ. അതുകൊണ്ട് ഈ പദ്ധതിയുടെ ഭാഗമായി പത്താംതരത്തിലെ ആത്യന്തിക വിലയിരുത്തലിനെ അഭിമുഖീകരിക്കാൻ കുട്ടികളെ സഹായിക്കുന്ന തരത്തിൽ വിവിധ വിഷയങ്ങളിൽ പുതിയ വിലയിരുത്തൽ സമീപനത്തിനനുസരിച്ച് ചോദ്യശേഖരം (Question Pool) പരിചയപ്പെടുത്താനാണ് ഇപ്രാവശ്യം ഉദ്ദേശിക്കുന്നത്. ജില്ലാ പഞ്ചായത്തിന്റെ നേതൃത്വത്തിൽ ഡയറ്റിന്റെ അക്കാദമിക സഹായത്തോടെ മലയാളത്തിലും ഇംഗ്ലീഷിലും കന്നഡയിലും പത്താം തരത്തിലെ ഐ.ടി. ഒഴികെയുള്ള വിഷയങ്ങളിൽ ചോദ്യശേഖരം തയ്യാറാക്കി നൽകാനാണ് ഉദ്ദേശിക്കുന്നത്. ഈ അധ്യയനവർഷം പത്താംതരം പരീക്ഷ എഴുതുന്ന മുഴുവൻ കുട്ടികൾക്കും ഈ പദ്ധതിയുടെ പ്രയോജനം ലഭിക്കുമെന്ന് പ്രതീക്ഷിക്കുന്നു. വ്യത്യസ്ത പഠനശേഷിയും പഠനമികവുമുള്ള എല്ലാ വിഭാഗം കുട്ടികൾക്കും ഈ സാമഗ്രി പ്രയോജനപ്പെടട്ടെ എന്ന് ആശംസിക്കുന്നു. ഒരു കൂട്ടം അധ്യാപകരുടെ ആത്മാർത്ഥമായ പ്രവർത്തനമാണ് ഈ സാമഗ്രി വികസിപ്പിക്കാൻ സഹായകമായത്. അധ്യാപകരുടെ ആത്മാർത്ഥമായ പിന്തുണയും പ്രോത്സാഹനവും അനിവാര്യമായ ഈ ഉദ്യമത്തിൽ എല്ലാവരുടെയും സഹായസഹകരണങ്ങൾ തുടർന്നും പ്രതീക്ഷിച്ചുകൊണ്ട് ഏവർക്കും വിജയാശംസകൾ നേരുന്നു. ആശംസകളോടെ,

ഡോ. രഘുരാമ ഭട്ട് കെ.
പ്രിൻസിപ്പാൾ
ഡയറ്റ് കാസറഗോഡ്



ആമുഖം

കാസറഗോഡ് ജില്ലാ പഞ്ചായത്തിന്റെ നേതൃത്വത്തിൽ ജില്ലയിലെ പൊതുവിദ്യാഭ്യാസം ശക്തിപ്പെടുത്തുന്നതിന് വ്യത്യസ്തങ്ങളായ നിരവധി പ്രവർത്തനങ്ങൾ നടന്നുവരികയാണ്. അതേസമയം ദേശീയ-സംസ്ഥാന പഠനങ്ങൾ നമ്മുടെ ജില്ലയിലെ കുട്ടികളുടെ പ്രകടനം ഇനിയും മെച്ചപ്പെടേണ്ടതുണ്ട് എന്ന സൂചനയാണ് നൽകുന്നത്. ഈ പശ്ചാത്തലത്തിലാണ് ജില്ലയിലെ പൊതുവിദ്യാലയങ്ങളിൽ നിന്ന് **2025-26** അധ്യയന വർഷം എസ്.എസ്.എൽ.സി. പരീക്ഷകൾ അഭിമുഖീകരിക്കുന്ന കുട്ടികൾക്ക് പഠനപിന്തുണ നൽകുന്നതിന് ജില്ലാ പഞ്ചായത്തിന്റെയും പൊതുവിദ്യാഭ്യാസ വകുപ്പിന്റെയും സംയുക്താഭിമുഖ്യത്തിൽ വ്യത്യസ്ത വിഷയങ്ങളിൽ പഠനസാമഗ്രികൾ തയ്യാറാക്കേണ്ടതിന്റെ ആവശ്യകത ജില്ലാതല ഉന്നതാധികാര യോഗങ്ങളിൽ ചർച്ചചെയ്യപ്പെട്ടത്. ഇതിന്റെ അടിസ്ഥാനത്തിൽ ഡയറ്റ് കാസറഗോഡിന്റെ അക്കാദമിക നേതൃത്വത്തിൽ ജില്ലയിലെ മികച്ച അധ്യാപകരെ ഉൾപ്പെടുത്തിക്കൊണ്ട് പത്താംതരത്തിൽ ഐ.ടി. ഒഴിച്ചുള്ള എല്ലാ വിഷയങ്ങളിൽ വിലയിരുത്തൽ സമീപനത്തിലനുസരിച്ച് ചോദ്യശേഖരം **(Question Pool)** തയ്യാറാക്കിയിരിക്കുകയാണ്. ജില്ലയിൽ നിന്നും പൊതുപരീക്ഷയെ അഭിമുഖീകരിക്കുന്ന മുഴുവൻ എസ്.എസ്.എൽ.സി, വിദ്യാർത്ഥികൾക്കും ആത്മവിശ്വാസം വളർത്തുന്നതിനും ഉന്നത വിജയം നേടുന്നതിനും ഈ ഉദ്യമം സഹായകമാകട്ടെയെന്ന് ആത്മാർത്ഥമായി ആഗ്രഹിക്കുന്നു. ഈ പദ്ധതിയെ നെഞ്ചേറ്റിയ പ്രിയപ്പെട്ട അധ്യാപക സുഹൃത്തുക്കൾക്ക് ഈ പുസ്തകത്തെ ഫലപ്രദമായി ഉപയോഗിക്കാൻ കഴിയട്ടെ.

എല്ലാവർക്കും വിജയാശംസകൾ.

ശ്രീ. മധുസൂദനൻ ടി. വി.
ജില്ലാ വിദ്യാഭ്യാസ ഉപഡയറക്ടർ
കാസറഗോഡ്

ENGLISH

Unit 1

TRIALS AND TRIUMPHS

A Verby Old Man with Enormous Wings

Comprehension – Textual Passage

A. **Read the excerpt from *A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings* and answer the questions that follow.**

The man was dressed like a ragpicker. There were only a few faded hairs left on his bald skull and very few teeth in his mouth. His pitiful condition seemed that of a drenched great-grandfather. This took away any sense of grandeur he might have had. His huge buzzard wings, dirty and half-plucked, were entangled in the mud.

They looked at him so long and so closely that Pelayo and Elisenda very soon overcame their surprise. In the end they found him familiar. Then they dared speak to him. He answered in an incomprehensible dialect with a strong sailor's voice.

They concluded that he was a lonely castaway from some foreign ship, wrecked by the storm. Then they called in a neighbour woman to see him. All she needed was one look to show them their mistake." He's an angel," she told them. "He must have been coming for the child, but the poor fellow is so old that the rain knocked him down."

1. What do you know about the physical features of the old man?
2. What happened to the huge buzzard wings of the strange creature?
3. What led Pelayo and Elisenda to the conclusion that the old man was a lonely castaway?

    A) His buzzard wings.

    B) His incomprehensible dialect.

    C) Appearance as a ragpicker.

    D) His strong sailor's voice.

Choose the right option:

i. A and B

ii. Only B

iii. Only D

iv. B and D

4. Find out a word from the passage which means ‘a stranded person’.

A) Rag picker

B) Captive

C) Castaway

D) Angel

5. What did the neighbour woman mean when she said, “He must have been coming for the child”?

B. Read the excerpt from *A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings* and answer the questions that follow.

The owners of the house had no reason to lament. With the money they saved they built a two-storey mansion with balconies and gardens. It also had high netting so that crabs wouldn’t get in during the winter, and iron bars on the windows so that angels wouldn’t get in.

Pelayo also set up a rabbit warren and gave up his job as a bailiff for good. Elisenda bought some satin pumps with high heels and many dresses of iridescent silk. The chicken coop was the only thing that didn’t receive any attention. The dung-heap stench from the coop was turning the new house into an old one.

1. Why didn’t the house owners have any reason to complain?

2. What provisions were made by the owners to make the house safer than earlier?

A) Balconies and garden

B) High netting

C) Iron bars on windows

D) High walls

Choose the right option:

i. A and D

ii. Only B

iii. Only C

iv. B and C

3. What did Pelayo set up when he quit his job as a bailiff?

A) Travelling show

B) Chicken coop

C) Gardens

D) Rabbit Warren

4. How did Elisenda try to bring a change in her dressing style?

5. Pick out a word from the passage that means 'a strong unpleasant smell'.

Discourses (7 Marks)

1. In the story *A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings* you have seen how the central character, an old and vulnerable man, was treated by other characters. Based on your reading of the story, prepare a **write up** on the human response to those who are old, vulnerable, dependent, and different.

   [Hints: Pelayo felt magnanimous in the beginning - locked him in a chicken coop – exhibited him for monetary benefit - the crowd treats him like a circus animal- considered as a burden - the old man remained patient]

2. Gabriel Garcia Marquez's short story, *A Very old Man with Enormous Wings* is a representation of hope, peace and resilience in the face of adversity. The story highlights the miserable plight of a lonely castaway. Based on your reading of the story, prepare a **review** focusing on the theme, plot development and characterisation.

   [Hints: - mysterious old man appears – locals unsure of his identity – the couple exploit him – fleeting interest of the society – despite being mistreated, the old man remains passive – grows stronger and flies away – magical realism.]

3. Pelayo's and Elisenda's way of treating the old man in the story, *A Very old Man with Enormous Wings* became the talk of the town. Even the media covered it. The inhuman attitude of the people against the vulnerable gets highlighted in an article in a daily. Prepare the likely **article**.

   [Hints: mysterious old man appears – lonely castaway - finds place in the chicken coop – ill treated - exploited – inhuman attitude towards the vulnerable – charge money – make fortune – neglect]

4. Atrocities towards the vulnerable can never be promoted in a society by any means. In the story, the old man was a victim of such a treatment from Pelayo and Elisenda. Prepare the script of a **speech** to be delivered on the International Day for Older Persons in the school assembly, based on the reading of the story *A Very old Man with Enormous Wings*.

Discourses (6 Marks)

5. Imagine you are Pelayo, recounting the events of the past few months. What was it like to live with a being you could not understand, and how did your life change because of him. **Narrate** your experiences.

6. The old man in the story *A Very old Man with Enormous Wings* is an embodiment of patience, calmness and peaceful behaviour. Prepare a **character sketch** of the old man focusing on his personality traits and behaviour.

7. The strong, sturdy and practical Pelayo is one of the main characters in the story *A Very old Man with Enormous Wings*. Prepare a detailed **character sketch** of Pelayo highlighting his physical and behavioural traits.

8. Elisenda is a rural woman who has a taste for luxury; she capitalizes on the situation when more visitors come to see the winged old man. On the basis of your reading of the story *A Very old Man with Enormous Wings*, prepare a **character sketch** of Elisenda highlighting the physical traits and personality traits.

9. Gabriel Garcia Marquez' story *A Very old Man with Enormous Wings* depicts how an old and vulnerable man was ill-treated by the people. Pelayo and Elisenda exhibited the old man and charged five cents. Imagine that you were a native of the place and witnessed such cruelties. Draft a **letter** of complaint to the Human Rights Commissioner, Cartagena requesting for immediate action.

10. Scores of people throng at Pelayo's house on knowing about the magical powers of the old man. Even the local dailies report it extensively. Prepare a **news report** covering the strange events happening at Pelayo's house.

11. The couple found it hard to manage the crowd that was pouring in to have a glimpse of the strange creature. Hence, Pelayo decides to send an email requesting the local police to help him in controlling the mob. Attempt the likely **email**.

12. Gabriel Garcia Marquez, one of the significant authors of the 20th century, was a master of magical realism. Using the details given below, prepare his **biographical sketch**.

Title: …….

Early life	:	born in Aracataca, Columbia in 1927- Raised by maternal grandparents - Grandmother, a story teller and childhood filled with stories. Studied at National University of Columbia – career – journalism.
Major works	:	Novels and short stories - Most famous one - One Hundred Years of Solitude (1967), a masterpiece of magical realism, The Autumn of Patriarch (1975), Chronicle of Death (1981), Love in the Time of Cholera (1985), concept of magical realism - focus on reality into fiction.
Personal life	:	spouse - Mercedes Barrcha, Two sons – Rodrigo (1959) and Gonzolo (1962)
Recognition and Legacy	:	Nobel prize for Literature in 1982 - lasting impact on world literature.
Later life	:	Final residence in Mexico, death 17 April 2014 (aged 87) - Mexico

13. Prepare a **profile** of William Shakespeare using the hints given.

Birth	:	April 23, 1564, Stratford-upon-Avon, Warwickshire, England
Parents	:	John Shakespeare, a glove-maker and Mary Arden, a land heiress
Occupation	:	Playwright, poet, actor
Major works	:	Hamlet, Macbeth, Othello, Romeo and Juliet
Style	:	Complex characters, poetic language
Main themes	:	Love, power, morality
Death	:	April 23, 1616 (aged 52)

Discourses (4 Marks)

14. The presence of the old man with enormous wings seems beneficial for Pelayo and his family in the beginning. But, later it becomes a burden to them. Finally, when the old man flies away, Elisenda feels much relieved of the situation. She expresses her feelings in a diary. Prepare the likely **diary.**

15. Empathy and kindness are virtues that help humanity to survive. How far does it prove to be valid in the story *An Old Man with Enormous Wings*? Write a **paragraph** on the inhuman attitude of Pelayo and Elisenda towards the old man.

16. The neighbour woman couldn't resist herself from sharing the details of the strange creature she came across at Pelayo's house with one of her friends. Write the **conversation** between them.

17. The news of the arrival of the old man with enormous wings spreads all over the locality. Many journalists conducted interviews with Pelayo to get more details about the old man. Being a journalist, **frame four questions** that you would like to ask Pelayo.

18. Read the following paragraph carefully and **frame four appropriate** questions based on it.

    One morning Elisenda was cutting some bunches of onions for lunch when a wind blew into the kitchen. Then she went to the window and found the angel in his first attempts at flight. These were so clumsy that he was on the point of knocking the shed down as he couldn't get a grip on the air. But then, he did manage to gain altitude. Elisenda let out a sigh of relief, for herself and for him, when she watched him pass over the last houses. He was holding himself up in some way with the risky flapping of a senile vulture.

Unit 1

A Very Old Man with Enormous Wing

ANSWERS

Comprehension – Textual Passage

A.

1. The old man had only a few faded hairs left on his bald skull and very few teeth in his mouth. He had huge buzzard wings.
2. His huge buzzard wings were entangled in the mud.
3. iv. B and D
4. C. Castaway
5. The neighbour woman meant that the angel must have come to safeguard the child from his illness.

B.

1. The owners had made a lot of money even to build a two-storied mansion. So, they didn't have any reason to complain about.
2. iv. B and C
3. D. Rabbit Warren
4. Elisenda bought satin pumps with high heels and many dresses of iridescent silk to bring a change in her dressing style.
5. stench

Discourses – Sample Answers

1. **Write up**

The Plight of the Vulnerable

Gabriel Garcia Marquez' story 'A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings' vividly portrays how people treat an old and vulnerable man. The arrival of the central

character, an old man with wings, created a mixed feeling in the minds of Pelayo and his wife Elisenda. At the outset, the presence of the old man created fear, anxiety and anguish among the local people. But, when Pelayo's child recovered from fever they believed that it was due to the presence of the old man. Hence, they felt magnanimous and decided to put the angel on a raft with fresh water and provisions for three days and leave him to his fate on the high seas.

Later the attitude of Pelayo and Elisenda changed when they saw a crowd in front of the house to see the old man. They had decided to utilize him for monetary benefit. Pelayo locked him in the chicken coop. Elisenda capitalized on the situation, charging an admission fee to see the angel. Pilgrims and others from afar visited the angel. Soon the people lost their interest when a travelling show arrived there with an attraction of a spider woman. The admission fee to see the spider woman was less than that of the angel. So, the people flocked to see her. Though Pelayo and Elisenda became wealthier they began to worry about the condition of the old man which was deteriorating day by day. The old man becomes a burden as well as an annoyance in their life. They longed for his departure. At the end when the old man attempted to fly away Elisenda let out a sigh of relief for her as well as for him.

8. Character sketch of Elisenda

Elisenda is one of the main characters of Gabriel Garcia Marquez's story 'A Very Old Man with Enormous Wings'. Her character highlights themes of greed, exploitation and the commodification of the miraculous. She is very practical and materialistic. When she sees an opportunity to capitalize on the old man's presence, she convinces Pelayo to charge admission fees, showcasing her entrepreneurial spirit.

Elisenda is resourceful and ambitious. She knows how to seize opportunities and accumulate wealth, which is evident in her idea to fence in the yard and charge visitors to see the old man. This resourcefulness helps her family become relatively wealthy too. She appears to be one who values material possessions and appearances. She buys satin pumps and iridescent silk dresses, symbolizing her desire for social status and

comfort. She lacks empathy, a basic character that a woman could have and this is evident in her treatment of the old man. She ignores his suffering and is relieved when he finally flies away. Elisenda reminds the readers about the emotional intelligence, detachment and self- centred behaviour of the ordinary people.

9. Formal letter

Romario Gonzaga

Rose Villa

Cartagena

12 Nov 2025

The Commissioner

The Human Rights Commission

Cartagena

Dear Sir/Madam,

Sub : Seeking action against the ill-treatment of an old and vulnerable man - reg

Your immediate attention to the following matter is requested.

I express my deep concern over the harsh treatment of the very old man with enormous wings, who has been recently discovered in our locality.

The old man is locked up in a chicken coop by one of my neighbour's Pelayo. People from different lands come here every day to see the old man and the visitors are being charged nearly five cents. Thus, Pelayo is exploiting the old man for monetary benefit and not giving any provisions to sustain his life. In fact, the old man is living in an unhygienic condition which causes threat to his life. Since his health is deteriorating

day by day, I request your immediate intervention in this matter. Hope you would do the needful at the earliest.

Yours faithfully,

sd/-

(Name)

18. Framing Questions

1. What was Elisenda doing in the kitchen?
2. What did Elisenda find when she looked out of the window?
3. Was the angel successful in his first attempt at flight?
4. Why did Elisenda let out a sigh of relief?

In the Attic

Comprehension – Textual Passage

A. Read the excerpt from *In the Attic* and answer the questions that follow.

When I placed my fingers on the keyboard they shook. I hadn't practised for two and half years, my fingers were stiff and covered with a thick layer of dirt, and I had not cut my nails for some weeks. I played Chopin's Nocturne in C sharp minor. When I finished, the silence seemed gloomy and eerie. I heard a shot down below outside the building – a harsh, loud German noise.

The officer looked at me in silence. After a while he sighed, and muttered, "All the same, you shouldn't stay here. I'll take you out of the city, to a village. You'll be safer there."

I shook my head. "I can't leave this place," I said firmly. Only now did he seem to understand my real reason for hiding among the ruins.

"You're Jewish?" he asked.

1. Why did the pianist's fingers shake when he played the piano?
2. What makes the pianist feel the silence as gloomy and eerie?

3. How did the German officer comfort the pianist?
   - A) He assured the pianist of taking him to a secure place.
   - B) He didn't assure the pianist of giving any help.
   - C) He warned the pianist of moving out.
   - D) He assured the pianist of taking him to his house.

4. What made the German officer remark, "You are Jewish."
   - A) The pianist was ready to leave the place.
   - B) The pianist couldn't leave the place.
   - C) The pianist had been hiding for a genuine reason.
   - D) The pianist believed that he had a danger of stepping out.

Choose the right option:

i. Only A
ii. A and D
iii. A and C
iv. B, C and D

5. Pick out a word from the passage that means – 'strange and frightening'

B. Read the excerpt from *In the Attic* and answer the questions that follow.

"If you and I have survived this inferno for over five years," he replied, "it's obviously God's will for us to live."

We had already said goodbye, and he was about to go, when an idea came to me at the last moment. I had long been racking my brains for some way of showing him my gratitude.

"Listen!" I took his hand and began speaking urgently. "I never told you my name you didn't ask me, but I want you to remember it. Who knows what may happen?

You have a long way to go home. If I survive, I'll certainly be working for Polish Radio again. I was there before the war. If anything happens to you, if I can help you then in any way, remember my name: Szpilman, Polish Radio." He smiled his usual smile, half shy and embarrassed, but I felt I had given him pleasure with my naive wish to help him.

1. How long had the pianist been living in exile?
2. What does 'rack one's brain' imply?
   A) Think deeply over
   B) Not think deeply
   C) Think with the least intent
   D) Over think
3. Why does the pianist stress the German officer on knowing each others' name?
   A) Knowing names is an integral part of knowing each other.

B) Knowing names doesn't bring familiarity.

C) Knowing names is a key to bonding.

D) Knowing names doesn't matter in any context.

Choose the right option:

i. A and D

ii. B and D

iii. A and C

iv. C and D

4. Pick out a synonym for 'naïve' in the context from the following.

A) Smart

B) Simple

C) Shrewd

D) Clever

5. How did the pianist intend to help the German officer in case they meet again?

Discourses (7 Marks)

1. The memoir, *In the Attic* reveals the horror, hardship and atrocities of war and Szpilman could overcome them with the help of a kind German officer, Wilm Hosenfeld. Based on your reading of the survivor testimony *In the Attic*, prepare a **write up** on 'How human bonding helps the world to move on in the face of war.'

[*Hints: Darkest chapters of World War II - Szpilman hides - threat of death - meets German officer - empathetic – provides necessities - compassion and human bonding - build hope and strength to survive*.]

2. Szpilman's memoir is a harrowing account of his survival during the Nazi occupation of Poland. The humanity and kindness bestowed on him by the German officer Wilm Hosenfeld was a great solace for Szpilman. Based on your

reading of the survivor testimony *In the Attic,* prepare an **article** highlighting the importance of empathy, kindness and hope in the face of adversity.

3. Wilm Hosenfeld's humanity and compassion helped Szpilman overcome the adverse conditions during the war. Inspired by his survivor testimony you plan to deliver a speech in the school assembly on the necessity of humanity and compassion. Prepare the likely **speech**.

Discourses (6 Marks)

4. *In the Attic* recounts the true story of the Polish pianist Wladyslaw Szpilman, who survived with the help of Wilm Hosenfeld. The story unveils an unusual friendship between a Jew and a German officer. **Narrate** the story in your own words focusing on the traumatic experience of Szpilman and his unusual friendship with the German officer.

5. The German coat that the pianist was wearing had nearly killed him when he tried to venture out. After reaching the military headquarters he narrates his experience to one of the mates. Write the likely **narrative**.

6. *In the Attic* depicts the true story of Wladyslaw Szpilman and his miraculous survival from the war having undergone a traumatic experience during his hiding. It speaks volumes about his attitude and character. Prepare the **character sketch** of Wladyslaw Szpilman.

7. The German officer Wilm Hosenfeld's humanity and compassion helped Szpilman to survive the atrocities of World War II. Their friendship was quite unusual, especially on a war front. Based on your reading of *In the Attic,* prepare the **character sketch** of Wilm Hosenfeld.

8. Szpilman could walk through the streets of Warsaw without fear as a free man for the first time in almost six years. He had mixed feelings as well. He shares his experiences with one of his friends through a letter. Draft the likely **letter**.

9. Wladyslaw Szlipman, a pianist and composer was a Polish Jew, who was forced to live in the ghetto during the Second World War. Using the given details, prepare a **biographical sketch** of Wladyslaw Szlipman.

Title: -_____

Early life and Career	:	Born in Sosnowiec, Poland, Dec.5, 1911. studied Piano – Fryderylc Chopin, University of music - Academy of Arts – Berlin.
Personal life	:	Parents - Samuel and Estera Szpilman. Spouse – Halina Gvzecznarowska Children - two sons, Andrzej and Christopher
Holocaust Survival	:	German invasion of Poland in 1939. Last live broadcast for Polish radio, Confined to Warsaw Ghetto, Two years in hiding-desolate - German officer extended help.
Post war life	:	Resumed career in 1963 - Polish radio - pianist - Chamber musician -Memoir Death of a City (1946) - Later published as The Pianist. Death - 6th July 2000 (Age 88)

10. Szpilman's story is a testament to the human spirit's capacity for survival and hope. Despite facing unimaginable challenges, he refused to give up, holding on to the hope of a better future. His narrow escape became the lead story in the news paper. Prepare the likely **news report**.

11. The English club of your school has decided to launch an anti-war campaign in connection with Hiroshima Day on August 06. Prepare an **event invitation** to be sent to nearby schools, which includes necessary details such as the purpose of the event, date, time, venue and the credentials of the chief guest.
12. The media world was really wonder struck at the news of Szpilman's survival in a loft in the attic. One of the channels arranges an interview with him. Imagine you are the interviewer; prepare **six questions** for the interview.

Discourses (4 Marks)

13. Wilm Hosenfeld's deed of helping Szpilman speaks volumes about him of being humane even in times of war. Write a **paragraph** on the necessity of being humane towards our fellow beings.
14. The virtues of love and compassion live forever, even in the midst of adversities. The friendship between Wilm Hosenfeld and Wladyslaw Szpilman led to the survival of the latter during World War II. Write a **paragraph** on the Significance of Love and Compassion in Modern Society based on the reading of the survivor testimony *In the Attic*.
15. Szpilman, wearing a German coat shouted hard and tried to convince the lieutenant that he was a Polish and not a German. Attempt the possible **conversation** between them.
16. Wilm Hosenfeld was deeply impressed by the pianist after watching him play Chopin's Nocturne in C sharp minor. After moving out of the place he jots down his feelings in his diary. Attempt the likely **diary**.
17. Read the passage given below and **frame four appropriate questions** based on it.

On 14 January unusual noises in the building and the street outside woke me. Soldiers ran up and down the stairs, and I heard agitated, nervous voices. Early in the morning of 15 January, the sound of artillery from the previously silent front was heard. The ground and the walls of the building shook under the constant dull thunder. Three hours later the heavy artillery fire died down again, but I was as nervous as ever. I did not sleep at all that night. The street fighting would begin at any moment, and I could be killed.

In The Attic

ANSWERS

Comprehension – Textual Passage

A.

1. The pianist's fingers shook when he played the piano because he hadn't practised for two and a half years.
2. The pianist was in the midst of life and death, so he feels the silence as gloomy and eerie.
3. A. He assured the pianist of taking him to a secure place.
4. (iv) B, C and D
5. eerie

B.

1. The pianist had been living in exile for over five years.
2. A. Think deeply over
3. (iii) A and C
4. B. Simple
5. In case the German officer needed any help he could meet Szpilman at Polish Radio and seek his help

Discourses – Sample Answers

1. Write up

The Light in the Ruins: Humanity amidst the Atrocities of War

"In the Attic' is an excerpt from Wladyslaw Szpilman's memoir' The Pianist: It is a testimony to the darkest chapters of the Second world war: It reveals the hardships and inhumane atrocities faced by people. The survivor testimony highlights enduring

hope and the power of human bonding. It clearly demonstrates how acts of kindness become the vital force that helps the world to move on in the face of war.

Szpilman hides in the ruins of Warsaw, starving with a constant threat of death. His condition reveals the helplessness of a victim in wartime. His unexpected encounter with the German officer, Wilm Hosenfeld contrasts to war's cruelty with a man's empathy. Instead of taking him as a prisoner the officer supports him, especially when he knows that Szpilman is a pianist. Music becomes a quiet but strong connection between them when Szpilman plays the piano after years of silence. The officer felt ashamed of the cruelties of his own country and acted against his army's declared policy with a strong moral sense. Hosenfeld's attitude establishes non-political, human to human connection. He provides Szpilman with shelter, food and safe refuge in the attic. His visit with bread and reassurances gives him the strength to survive. This is the essence of human bonding. Szpilman's survival is not a solitary achievement; it is facilitated by the moral choice of a man on the opposite side. It provides the physical means to live and the hope to face the future.

The unspeakable pain and cruelty of war is illustrated here and also proves the fact that war cannot entirely extinguish the human capacity for kindness. Szpilman's story is a profound reminder that moments of unexpected kindness and compassion are the greatest weapons against despair of war. It provides the light needed for individuals and the world to ultimately overcome its darkest moments.

9. Biographical sketch

Wladyslaw Szpilman

Wladyslaw Szpilman was a Polish Jew and a celebrated pianist and composer. He was forced to live in the Warsaw ghetto during the Second World War.

He was born in Sosnowiec, Poland, on December 5, 1911. He pursued his passion, studying piano at the Fryderyk Chopin University of Music and later at the Academy of Arts in Berlin. By 1935, he had returned to Poland and began to work as a composer for Polish Radio. He composed popular songs and orchestral works.

His parents were Samuel and Estera Szpilman. He was married to Halina Grzecznarowska, and they had two sons Andrzej and Christopher.

His life changed by the German invasion of Poland in 1939. He gave his live broadcast for Polish Radio just before the Station was bombed. As a Jewish man he was confined to the Warsaw Ghetto. He spent two years in hiding. Finally, he received help from a German officer, Captain Wilm Hosenfeld.

After the war Szpilman resumed his career in 1963 as a composer, pianist and a chamber Musician in the Polish Radio. His memoir was initially, published in 1946 and again re-released as 'The Pianist'.

He passed away on July 6, 2000 at the age of 88. 'The Pianist' is still remembered as a testament to resilience and human spirit amidst war.

11. Event Invitation

ABC School, Thiruvananthapuram

Anti-War Campaign

Respected Headmaster and teachers,

The English Club of our school has decided to launch an ***Anti-War Campaign*** in connection with Hiroshima Day on August 06, 2026. The programme aims at creating awareness among the people regarding the atrocities of war.

The programme will start at 10 a.m. in the school auditorium with an inaugural session presided over by the renowned survivor of World War II, Wladyslaw Szpilman, who will also be the Chief Guest. Eminent personalities from various realms of the society will also grace the proceedings.

The highlight of the campaign would be screening of *Documentaries, Debates and Discussions on War with a special Panel Discussion* led by *Wladyslaw Szpilman*.

We request your esteemed presence on this occasion.

Thiruvananthapuaram
01.08.2026

Sd/-
Secretary
English Club

12. Interview questions

1. How did you reach the attic?
2. What were your thoughts while staying in the attic so long?
3. Wasn't it difficult to stay in hiding for such a long time?
4. How could you manage everything?
5. Who are the other survivors of your family?
6. What is your message to the people?

17. Framing Questions

1. What happened on 14th July?
2. What did the soldiers do when they heard the agitated nervous voices?
3. When did the narrator hear the sound of artillery?
4. Was the narrator able to sleep peacefully at night?

Friends, Romans, Countrymen..

Comprehension - Textual Poem/Extract

A. Read the lines from the dramatic speech, *Friends, Romans, Countrymen…* and answer the questions that follow.

I come to bury Caesar, not to praise him.
The evil that men do lives after them;
The good is oft interred with their bones;
So let it be with Caesar. The noble Brutus
Hath told you Caesar was ambitious:
If it were so it was a grievous fault;
And grievously hath Caesar answered it.
Here, under leave of Brutus and the rest,
For Brutus is an honourable man;
So are they all, honourable men,
Come I to speak in Caesar's funeral.

1. What is the significance of Antony's opening line, "I come to bury Caesar not to praise him"?

   A) It shows Antony's disrespect for Caesar.

   B) It establishes Antony's intention to be neutral.

   C) It signals Antony's desire to take revenge on Caesar's killers.

   D) It reflects Antony's loyalty to Brutus.

2. In the line, "The evil that men do lives after them; the good is oft interred with their bones," what is Antony trying to suggest?

   A) People tend to forget the bad things about others.

B) People tend to remember only the bad deeds of the dead.

C) People remember only the good deeds of the dead.

D) All deeds are equally remembered after death.

3. Pick out an example of irony from the given lines.

4. Why does Antony refer to Brutus as "the noble Brutus" in his speech?

B. Read the following lines from the dramatic speech, *Friends, Romans, countrymen...* and answer the questions that follow.

You all did see that on the Lupercal

I thrice presented him a kingly crown,

Which he did thrice refuse: was this ambition?

Yet Brutus says he was ambitious;

And, sure, he is an honourable man.

I speak not to disprove what Brutus spoke,

But here I am to speak what I do know.

You all did love him once, not without cause:

What cause withholds you, then, to mourn for him?

O Judgement thou art fled it to brutish beasts,

And men have lost their reason!-Bear with me;

My heart is in the coffin there with Caesar,

And I must pause till it come back to me.

1. How does Antony try to prove that Caesar was not ambitious?

2. According to Antony, what is the purpose of his speech?

A) To prove what Brutus said was right.

B) To disprove what Brutus said was right.

C) To speak out his mind.

D) To prove Caesar was ambitious.

3. Which poetic device is used in the line," My heart is in the coffin there with Caesar"?

4. What does Antony expect from the rhetorical question, "What cause withholds you, then, to mourn for him?"

A) The crowd's explanation for not mourning.

B) The crowd's explanation for having loved Caesar.

C) The crowd expressing regret for their love.

D) The crowd realising their mistake and mourn for Caesar.

C. Read the following lines from the dramatic speech *Friends Romans Countrymen* and prepare an appreciation focusing on the theme, poetic devices and persuasive techniques.

Friends, Romans, countrymen, lend me your ears:

l come to bury Caesar, not to praise him.

The evil that men do lives after them,

The good is oft interred with their bones.

So let it be with Caesar. The noble Brutus

Hath told you Caesar was ambitious.

If it were so, it was a grievous fault,

And grievously hath Caesar answered it.

Here, under leave of Brutus and the rest

For Brutus is an honorable man;

So are they all, all honorable men,

Come I to speak in Caesar's funeral

D. Here are two excerpts from the play Julius Caesar. They are the words of Brutus and Mark Antony, delivered on the occasion of Caesar's funeral.

Brutus (simplified):	**Mark Antony (original):**
"I cared for Caesar deeply.....But I loved Rome even more. Would you rather have Caesar alive, and all of us be slaves, or have Caesar dead so we can all be free? I cried for him because I loved him. I was happy for his successes and admired his bravery. But because he was ambitious, I killed him."	"You all did see that on the Lupercal I thrice presented him a kingly crown, Which he did thrice refuse: was this ambition? Yet Brutus says he was ambitious; And, sure, he is an honourable man."

Brutus and Mark Antony both speak about Caesar's ambition and their love for him. Brutus says Caesar had to die for the good of Rome, while Antony argues that Caesar did not seem ambitious at all. Whose words do you find more convincing, and what is each speaker trying to make the people believe? Draft your response in a **paragraph**.

Friends, Romans, Countrymen..

ANSWERS

Comprehension - Textual Poem/Extract

A.

1. B - It establishes Antony's intention to remain neutral.
2. B - People tend to remember only the bad deeds of the dead.
3. 'Brutus is an honourable man'
4. To mock Brutus's self perceived nobility.

B.

1. Antony tried to prove that Caesar was not ambitious by citing that Caesar had rejected the kingly crown thrice.
2. C .To speak out his mind
3. Hyperbole
4. D. The crowd realise their mistake and mourn for Caesar.

D. Sample Answer - Paragraph - Thematic Comparison

The two excerpts taken from the renowned Shakespearian play 'Julius Caesar' focus on the assassination of Julius Caesar. While Brutus states that Caesar had to die for the good of Rome, Antony argues that Caesar did not seem ambitious at all. The charge against Caesar made by Brutus is that he was ambitious. Through his speech, Brutus defends the assassination as necessary for Rome's liberty, stating he loved Caesar but Rome more. He says to the Romans "If Caesar continued in the throne, we would be living as slaves". Brutus in his speech upheld his love for the nation and its people rather than Caesar. But he fails to justify his deed of killing Caesar. On the other hand, Mark Antony stated that Caesar was not ambitious by providing ample examples like Caesar's refusal of the kingly crown. Antony highlights Caesar's positive deeds, such as filling the treasury with ransoms and weeping for the poor, and vehemently

attacks Brutus's claim that Caesar was ambitious. His eloquent use of repetition, notably repeating, "Brutus says he was ambitious/And Brutus is an honourable man," serves to undermine the credibility of Brutus.

Language Elements

Reported Speech

A. Report the following dialogue.

1. Hosenfeld : Don't come out of the attic.

   Szpilman: Ok. I will stay here itself.

2. Hosenfeld : Are you a Jew?

   Szpilman : Yes. I am. I was in the ghetto and reached this place anyhow.

B. Report the following dialogue.

1. Pelayo : Can't we lock the old man with the hens in the chicken coop?

   Elisenda :Yes. It can be done.

2. Neighbour woman : Why don't you treat the angel in a better way?

   Elisenda : The angel doesn't need a place better than this.

Cloze Type

Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the bracket.

1. The light was weak, even ——(a)— noon. When Pelayo was coming back —— (b)—— the house, it was hard ——(c)—— him to see what was moving —— (d)—— groaning —— (e)—— the rear ——(f)—— the courtyard.

(and, in, at, of, to, for)

2. ——(a)—— the following day everyone knew that ———(b)——— flesh-and-blood angel was held captive ——(c)—— Pelayo's house. Pelayo watched ——(c)—— him all afternoon ——(d)—— the kitchen, armed ——(f)—— his bailiff's club.

(with, over, on, from, in, a)

3. When I placed my fingers ——(a)—-- the keyboard they shook. I hadn't practised ——(b)—— two and half years, my fingers were stiff ——(c)—— covered ——(d)—— a thick layer ——(e)—— dirt, and I had not cut my nails for some weeks. I played Chopin's Nocturne —— (f)—— C sharp minor.

(with, on, in, for, and, of)

4. Early ——(a)—— the morning ——(b)—— 15 January, the sound of artillery ——(c)—— the previously silent front was heard. The ground ——(d)—— the walls of the building shook ——(e)—— the constant dull thunder. Three hours later the heavy artillery fire died down again, ——(f)—— I was as nervous as ever.

(under, in, from, but, of, and)

Editing

Edit the passage. The errors are given in bold.

1. He **could not scarcely** (a) eat, and his eyes had also become so **fogy** (b) that he went about bumping into a post. Pelayo **throws** (c) a blanket over him, and **let's** (d) him sleep **at** (e) the shed. Only then did they notice that he **has** (f) temperature at night.

2. The Germans **had withdrew** (a) without a fight. As soon as it began to get **lite** (b), l prepared **feverish** (c) for my first venture out. My officer had left me **an** (d) German military overcoat to **kept** (e) me from freezing. l had already **put on it** (f) when I suddenly heard the rhythmic footsteps of guards out in the road again.

Phrasal Verbs

Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in bracket.

1. A huge crowd ……(a)…… to have a glimpse of the strange creature. Although, it was difficult to manage Pelayo and Elisenda decided to ……(b)…… with it. They thought it was better to ……..(c)…… the crowd anyhow because if they ……..(d)…… the visitors, it will affect their income. In fact, the couple was ……(e)……. improving their fortune rather than thinking about the old man.
   [look forward to, turn up, put up with, get on, put away, put forward]

2. The German officer ……(a)…….. Szpilman's hide-out. There he ……..(b)……. a piano. He requested Szpilman to play it. Although he hadn't touched it for years, he decided to give it a try. He moved his fingers over it and in no time ……..(c)….. playing, to the amazement of the officer. Actually, he couldn't …….(d)…… his genuine passion, something he had done for his life. Moreover, ……(e) …….. something he liked the most was unimaginable for him too.

   [go on, put aside, do away with, call at, put away, come across]

Completion of Dialogue

1. Complete the following dialogue between Pelayo and his wife Elisenda.

Pelayo : The winged man was here till this morning, …….(a).....?

Elisenda : Yes, he was there in the courtyard.

Pelayo : ……. (b).....?

Elisenda : I felt a wind blowing into the kitchen.

Pelayo : …… (c).....?

Elisenda : Yes. I checked. But I couldn't do much.

Pelayo : You had better (d) .....

Elisenda : If I had stopped him, (e).....

2. Complete the following conversation between the Polish officer and Szpilman.

Polish Officer : You are a German, ……..(a)……?

Szpilman : No. I'm Polish.

Polish Officer : ……(b)……..?

Szpilman : I am in a German coat because it was given to me by a German officer.

Polish Officer : You sound little awkward.

Szpilman : ……..(c)……?

Polish Officer : Yes. I have doubt.

Szpilman : If you don't trust me, …….(d)……

Polish Officer : Let me see.

Szpilman : Would you mind ……..(e)…….

Polish Officer : I will surely help you.

Vocabulary

1. Complete each sentence using appropriate forms of words given in brackets.

A. It was a .....(a).....day to do things in order and finish them .....(b)..... (perfect)

B. The .....(a).....children did their tasks.....(b)..... (happy)

2. Create pairs from the words given in the box below and complete the sentences.

A. The pianist couldn't make out the ....., that came from the streets.

B. The crowd that had gathered around with ..... waited eagerly for the show to begin.

(unusual, tremendous, enthusiasm, noise, effort)

Unit 1

Language Elements - ANSWERS

Reported Speech

A. Report the following dialogue.

1. Hosenfeld warned Szpilman not to come out of the attic.

   Szpilman agreed and said that he would stay there itself.

2. Hosenfeld asked Szpilman whether he was a Jew.

   Szpilman asserted and said that he had been in the ghetto and had reached that place anyhow.

B. Report the following dialogue.

1. Pelayo asked Elisenda whether they couldn't lock the old man with the hens in the chicken coop.

   Elisenda agreed and said that it could be done.

2. Neighbour woman asked Elisenda why she didn't treat the angel in a better way.

   Elisenda replied that the angel didn't need a place better than that.

Cloze Type

1. (a) at (b) to

   (c) for (d) and

   (e) in (f) of

2. (a) On (b) a
(c) in (d) over
(e) from (f) with

3. (a) on (b) for
(c) and (d) with
(e) of (f) in

4. (a) in (b) of
(c) from (d) and
(e) under (f) but

Editing

1. (a) could scarcely
(b) foggy
(c) threw
(d) let
(e) in
(f) had

2. (a) had withdrawn
(b) light
(c) feverishly
(d) a
(e) keep
(f) put it on

Phrasal Verbs

1. (a) turned up
(b) get on
(c) put up with

(d) put away

(e) looking forward to

2. (a) called at

(b) came across

(c) went on

(d) put aside

(e) doing away with

Completion of Dialogue

1. (a) wasn't he?

(b) What happened then?

(c) Did you check?

(d) stop him.

(e) he would have continued to be a burden.

2. (a) aren't you?

(b) Why are you in a German coat?

(c) Are you having any doubt?

(d) you can arrest me.

(e) helping me.

Vocabulary

1. A. (a) perfect (b) perfectly

B. (a) happy (b) happily

2. (a) unusual noise

(b) tremendous enthusiasm

Unit 2

PATHS to PROGRESS

Breaking Barriers, I will Fly

Comprehension – Textual Passage

A. Read the excerpt from *Breaking Barriers, I will Fly* and answer the questions that follow.

Eventually, my parents and relatives decided that I should study in a school with students like me. So, I was sent to a special school in Hyderabad. There I excelled, becoming an outstanding student, earning top ranks, and representing India in chess and cricket. I had the privilege of working with Dr A.P.J. Abdul Kalam on various projects like the Lead India Youth Transformation Project.

When I completed my 10th grade with over 90% marks I wanted to study science at the A.P. State Board. However, I was told I could only take arts because I was 'impaired.' I did not consider myself visually impaired but visually 'challenged.' I was not allowed to pursue my passion due to the perceptions of others. Rather than accept this, I decided to sue the government.

1. What did the parents decide in the better interest of Srikanth?
2. How did Srikanth fare at his new school?

3. Which statement among the following is NOT TRUE with respect to Srikanth?
   - A) He was denied the opportunity to take Arts.
   - B) He was not allowed to take Science.
   - C) He was allowed to take Science.
   - D) He was allowed to take Arts.

Choose the right option:

   - i. Only A
   - ii. Only B

iii. Only C

iv. Neither C nor D

4. What did Srikanth decide when he was allowed to pursue his passion?

   A) Give up his dreams

   B) Put up with the options

   C) Get over the problems

   D) Go on with the tide

5. Identify the **Noun Phrase** in the subject position and the **Verb Phrase** in the following sentence.

   My parents and relatives decided that I shall study in a school with students like me.

B. Read the excerpt from *Breaking Barriers, I will Fly* and answer the questions that follow.

While at MIT, I began to think deeply about my future. Should I just get married, settle down and work in corporate America? No, I wanted to solve the problems I had faced. Why should blind children be made to sit on the last bench? Why should 10% of India's population, who are disabled, be excluded from the economy?

These questions led me back to India, where I returned, giving up all the opportunities in corporate America, to build a strong support system for the disabled.

1. What was the confusion in the mind of Srikanth, while he was at the MIT?
2. What did Srikanth resolve?
3. I began to <u>think deeply</u>. Replace the underlined part with the most suitable word/phrase.

   A) Disregard

   B) Neglect

C) Ponder

D) Ignore

4. Srikanth gave up all opportunities in corporate America to build a strong support for the disabled. What does this tell about his attitude?

   A) He was overambitious.

   B) He was ambitious.

   C) He was thoughtful.

   D) He was least bothered about others.

Discourses (7 Marks)

1. Your school is hosting a programme in honour of the 'Inspirational Hero' Srikanth Bolla. As the school captain, you have been asked to deliver a speech on the theme, "Overcoming Obstacles to Achieve Greatness." Drawing inspiration from his life, prepare a **speech** to be delivered in the school assembly.

2. The success story of Srikant Bolla is clearly an eye opener since he overcame the obstacles in life with hard work, perseverance and dedication. His resilience is exemplary too. Prepare an **article** on Srilkant's ordeals in life based on the reading of, *Breaking Barriers, I will Fly*.

   [Hints: born without eyes - ignored by teachers and classmates – joined in a special school – wanted to study science – legal battle - support of the mentor – got admission in MIT – came back to India – support in education and vocational rehabilitation – set up Bollant industries – gave job to 150 disabled individuals]

3. Any youngster who gets an opportunity to study in the United States would just get married, settle down and work in corporate America. Srikanth Bolla was a

man with a difference. He decided to return to India. Prepare a **write-up** detailing the impact of Bolla's return on the disabled community.

[Hints:- study at MIT in the USA - could have had a comfortable life - chose to return to India - founded Bollant industries - became a role model and job creator.]

Discourses (6 Marks)

4. Srikanth Bolla emerged as a successful entrepreneur by fighting against his own limitations and challenges from society. His enterprise turned out to be a pillar of support to many. **Narrate** the success story of Srikanth Bolla in your own words.

5. The news of Bollant Industries taking the initiative of rehabilitating, nurturing and reintegrating disabled individuals gets reported in one of the national dailies. Prepare the likely **news report**.

6. Srikanth Bolla got admission into MIT, USA as its first international blind student. This as news gets reported in one of the leading dailies in Massachusetts. Prepare the likely **news report**.

7. Srikanth Bolla had to sue the government to study science at the A. P. State Board after the 10th grade. Even then he could score 98% with the personal guidance of his teacher. Imagine that after his admission at MIT, Srikanth writes a letter to thank his teacher. Draft the likely **letter**.

8. Srikanth considered himself as visually "challenged" rather than "impaired". He was thankful to MIT Massachusetts for giving him an opportunity to become their first international blind student as well. He drafts an e-mail to the President, MIT expressing his gratitude. Draft the likely **e-mail.**

9. Imagine that you are interviewing Srikanth Bolla based on his journey of overcoming visual impairment to build a successful company like Bollant Industries. Prepare **six questions** to interview him.

Discourses (4 Marks)

10. The English Club of your school has decided to host a special felicitation ceremony to honour Srikanth Bolla, the social entrepreneur who recently received the SJIM Eminent social entrepreneur award from the St. Joseph's Institute of Management. As the secretary of the English Club, prepare an **event invitation** to be sent to teachers, students and other guests, which includes necessary details such as the purpose of the event, date, time and venue etc... of the ceremony.

11. Srikanth was immensely hurt to know that he was being denied admission into science, although it was his passion. He even decides to sue the government. Write his disturbed feelings as his **diary entry**.

12. Studying in a general school left Srikanth Bolla with loneliness and isolation. So his relatives and parents have a discussion about sending him to a school with students like him. Draft the likely **conversation** between Srikanth's father and one of his relatives.

Breaking Barriers; I will Fly

ANSWERS

Comprehension – Textual Passage

A.

1. The parents decided that Srikanth should study in a school with students like him.
2. Srikanth excelled and became an outstanding student, earning top ranks and representing India in chess and cricket.
3. iii. Only C
4. C. Get over the problems
5. Noun Phrase – My parents and relatives

   Verb Phrase – decided that I shall study in a school with students like me

B.

1. He was confused whether he should get married, settle down and work in corporate America, or solve the problems he had faced.
2. Srikanth resolved to give up all opportunities in corporate America and build a strong support system for the disabled in India.
3. C. Ponder
4. C. He was thoughtful.

Discourses – Sample Answers

1. Speech

Our esteemed guest, Mr. Srikanth Bolla, respected Principal, teachers, and my dear friends,

Today, we are honoured to host a programme in celebration of an extraordinary and inspirational hero. His life stands as a powerful example of overcoming challenges and rising to greatness. Sir, your presence here truly inspires every one of us.

For those who may not be familiar with his journey, Mr. Srikanth Bolla was born visually challenged in a small village. Along with his disability, he also had to face the harshness of social prejudice. After scoring an outstanding 90% in his 10th standard, he had to fight a legal battle just to study science. Imagine that! With immense determination, he recorded his own textbooks, worked tirelessly, and scored an incredible 98% in his higher secondary examination. Yet, he was denied admission to IIT because of his blindness. But he did not give up. He pursued his dreams and secured admission to the prestigious MIT in the USA. Isn't he a true lesson for all of us?

After completing his studies, he returned to India with a mission to solve the problems faced by persons with disabilities. He founded Bollant Industries, a company that produces eco-friendly products and provides employment to over 150 disabled individuals. As Srikanth himself has said, "True wealth doesn't come from money, but from the happiness of others." He teaches us three valuable lessons: to show compassion and help others grow, to remove loneliness from people's lives, and to remember that when we do something meaningful, we ourselves benefit first.

Let us all draw inspiration from this remarkable man. On behalf of the entire school, I extend my heartfelt congratulations to Mr. Srikanth Bolla, and I sincerely thank you, sir, for showing us that with vision, hard work, and compassion, no barrier is strong enough to stop us from achieving greatness.

Thank you.

2. Article

Srikant Bolla: A True Symbol of Strength and Resilience

Success stories often begin with struggle, and the life of Srikanth Bolla is a shining example. Born in 1992 in a small village in Andhra Pradesh, Srikanth came into the world visually impaired. His parents, who were poor farmers, faced criticism from society, and many even advised them to abandon the child. But Srikanth's parents chose to support him with love and care.

Life was never a smooth sail for Srikanth. Despite the challenges of trekking to a faraway school he was ignored by teachers and classmates. He was denied the opportunity to choose Science and Mathematics even after scoring 90% marks in 10th grade. However, Srikanth refused to bow down to such discrimination. He fought a legal battle and won the right to pursue the subjects of his choice. His determination soon bore fruit when he cleared his exams with flying colours.

When he applied to the prestigious IITs, he faced rejection once again. But failure never discouraged him. Instead, he aimed higher and applied abroad. His hard work and perseverance were rewarded when he was admitted to the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), USA, becoming the first visually impaired international student at the institute.

After completing his studies, Srikanth returned to India with a vision to empower others like him. He founded Bollant Industries, a company that manufactures eco-friendly disposable products. More importantly, the company employs hundreds of differently-abled people, giving them a chance to live with dignity and independence.

Today, Srikanth Bolla is not just a successful entrepreneur but also a symbol of hope and courage. His story teaches us that with clear vision, perseverance, and determination, no obstacle is too great. He proves that true vision comes not from eyesight, but from the mind and heart.

9. Interview Questions

1. Who inspired you to become an entrepreneur?
2. What led you to the founding of Bollant industries?
3. What is the mission of Bollant industries regarding disabled individuals?
4. How can society become more supportive and inclusive in your opinion?
5. Among your achievements, which one makes you feel most proud of?
6. What is your definition of “true wealth”?

11. Diary

15 Nov 2025

Monday

How can they do this to me? It’s not right. I too should have my chances. Science is my passion. How can they deny me a seat only because I am visually impaired? Is disability a curse? People like me exist. We too have dreams. We have a heart too. Why don’t people understand and treat us at par? If they feel that we aren’t capable, it is absolutely wrong. We should be given opportunities. Then only we can prove ourselves. I won’t leave this matter and give in to my fate. I will voice my concern against this injustice. I shall lodge a complaint and sue the government. I will certainly do it because it’s a matter of our rights. Let’s see what unfolds.

A Phoenix Rises

Comprehension -Textual Passage

A. Read the excerpt from *A Phoenix Rises* and answer the questions that follow.

Bablu Kewat had been an indifferent student at best. He still remembers his science teacher Mrs Sharma, and the egg incubator that he had made under her supervision. But when Bablu's father died leaving his mother struggling to support her small family, he dropped out of school to get a job and help her out.

He joined a workshop as a busboy, getting tea for the owner. He slowly worked his way up to becoming a welder. Gradually he took over the mortgage of the workshop. After that, he ran the business himself, growing it steadily.

1. What might be the reason Bablu remembers his science teacher?
2. Why did Bablu resort to finding a job?
3. How was Bablu able to overcome the challenges in his early life?
   - A) with his resilience
   - B) with his hard work
   - C) with his perseverance
   - D) All of the above

4. Pick out a word from the passage which means 'a property pledged to a bank for a loan'.

5. Pick the synonym for 'busboy' from the following.
   - A) master
   - B) lord
   - C) steward
   - D) host

B. Read the excerpt from *A Phoenix Rises* and answer the questions that follow.

He continued his experiments knowing that most women used unclean rags instead of sanitary napkins as they could not afford them, He also knew that this made them prone to disease. No one else appeared to be bothered by this. He looked at the little girls running around the neighbourhood. They couldn't even buy a good pair of slippers how could they ever afford to buy sanitary pads month after month?

However, his experiments and his obsession caused some unrest even in the family. His mother beseeched him to stop the experiments saying that the whole family would be disgraced by his sordid interest in women's menstrual cycles. The news was gradually spreading in the village and the villagers entangled the whole family in a mesh of coarse whispers and rude glances.

1. How did Bablu know that women cannot afford the sanitary pads every month?
2. Why did Bablu continue his experiment?
   - A) Women used unclean rags instead of sanitary napkins.
   - B) He wanted to sell the sanitary napkins at an exorbitant price.
   - C) He wished to be a scientist.
   - D) Women could not afford sanitary napkins.

Choose the right option:

- i) Only A
- ii) Both A and B
- iii) Only C
- iv) Both A and D

3. What made the women prone to diseases as per Bablu?

4. What was the reaction of the villagers towards Bablu's experiment?
   - A) The villages supported him.
   - B) The villagers arranged materials for the production of sanitary napkins.

C) The villagers filed a case against him.

D) The villagers reacted with coarse whispers and rude glances.

5. Identify the **Noun Phrase** in the subject position and the **Verb Phrase** from the sentence given below.

The news was gradually spreading in the village.

Discourses (7 Marks)

1. Mr. Muruganantham was a simple welder whose life had been ripped apart, due to the narrow mindedness and biased judgement of the society. Based on your reading of Twinkle Khanna's story and Muruganantham's interview, prepare an **article** on the victory of perseverance and dedication over social bias.

2. The life of Arunachalam Muruganantham truly shows that the seeds of social entrepreneurship are sowed in the need and passion to work in the best interest of the society and its people. Based on the reading of '*A Phoenix Rises*', prepare a **speech** on Social Entrepreneurship.

3. Entrepreneurship has an immense potential in the wake of Make in India and Kerala Start up Mission initiatives launched by the government. Imagine you are asked to deliver a speech on the topic, Entrepreneurship – Opening Doors for the Future. Prepare the script of the **speech** to be delivered at the congregation of students assembled for the YIP Launch programme in your school.

4. 'Nothing is impossible in this world' seems very apt when we go through the life of Arunachalam Muruganantham in *A Phoenix Rises*. Prepare a **write-up** on the importance of perseverance and resilience in overcoming the challenges in one's life with examples from the life of the great social entrepreneur.

Discourse – (6 Marks)

5. Bablu was pursuing his dream of benefiting the umpteen women, but nobody was willing to understand his motive, even his family members. He narrates his hardships in accomplishing his dream to one of his friends. Attempt the likely **narrative**.

6. Bablu's determination had found its way regardless of the unrest in his family and criticisms from his community. He showed to the world that dedication and social commitment are the key features of his personality. Prepare a **character sketch** of Bablu.

7. Gowri was averse to the ways of Bablu when he started his experiments to create affordable sanitary napkins. How do you describe the character of Gowri in the story, *A Phoenix Rises*? Prepare a **character sketch** of Gowri.

8. Bablu's wife leaves him unable to bear the humiliation due to his antics. But, he was firm with his ideas. He decides to write a letter to his wife sharing his plans and the social cause. Attempt the likely **letter**.

9. Arunachalam Muruganantham sells his machines at a subsidised price to women's self help groups. Being the co-coordinator of the Kudumbashree unit in your locality, you decide to avail the machines for the unit. Draft an **e-mail** to Arunachalam Muruganantham expressing your intent.

10. **Prepare the profile of Twinkle Khanna using the hints given below.**

Born	:	December 29, 1974
Parents	:	Rajesh Khanna, Dimlple Kapadia
Career	:	Acting (first movie, Barsaat), Interior designing (launching her own studio White Window), Writing (first book, Mrs. Funnybones, 2015)

Marriage	:	Akshay Kumar, 2001
Children	:	Arav, Nitara
Philanthrophy	:	Women's empowerment and education
Achievements	:	India Today Woman Writer (2016)

11. The Science Club of your school intends to organise a seminar in accordance with the launch of YIP (Young Innovators Programme) in your district. Being the Secretary of the club, you are asked to prepare a **notice** with all the necessary details. Draft the likely notice.

12. Arunachalam Muruganantham was conferred with the prestigious Padma Shri Award in 2016 for his ground breaking invention of a low cost sanitary pad making machine. The news gets extensively covered in the media too. Prepare the **news report**.

13. Gowri was not pleased with Bablu's idea of using sanitary napkins, because she felt they couldn't afford such stuff. Attempt the likely **conversation** between them.

14. Bablu was totally disappointed when his wife Gowri left him. Moreover, he faced many criticisms regarding his experiments from his own family and community. What would be his thoughts in such a situation? Write his **thoughts** in a paragraph.

15. Read the passage given below and **frame four appropriate questions** based on it.

    Bablu was gloomy for a while at the thought of stopping his experiments. But he devised an idea to conduct experiments on himself rather than others. With the help of a friend, he collected some blood. Using a rubber tube, he experimented with the napkins himself. One day, Lata, his neighbour Parul's daughter, happened to see this.

The next day all kinds of rumours spread over the small town. Unable to bear the humiliation, Bablu's wife left him. She said she would only return when he gave up his madness.

16. The Science club of your school has started a unit to produce LED Bulbs. Prepare two rhythmic sentences that can be used to create **advertisement jingles** to promote the product.

17. One of the Kudumbashree units in your locality produces umbrellas of rich varieties. To promote their products, prepare rhythmic sentences that can be used to create **advertisement jingles**.

A Phoenix Rises

ANSWERS

Comprehension – Textual Passage

A.

1. Bablu had made an egg incubator under the supervision of his science teacher. This might be the reason he remembers her.
2. Bablu resorted to finding a job to help and support his struggling mother and family.
3. D. All of the above.
4. mortgage
5. C. steward

B.

1. When Bablu knew that women used unclean rags instead of sanitary napkins, he realised that they could not afford them.
2. iv. Both A and D
3. The use of unclean rags made the women prone to diseases as per Bablu.
4. D. The villagers reacted with coarse whispers and rude glances.
5. Noun Phrase – The news
   Verb Phrase – was gradually spreading in the village

Discourses – Sample Answers

8. Informal Letter

Coimbatore,

25 Oct 2025

Dear Gowri,

I am writing this letter to share my genuine thoughts and concerns with you.

I know you are angry with me. You may think I am mad. Even you maybe of the opinion, what in the world prompt me from doing all these things. But, I would like

to tell you that my sole purpose is to benefit the poor women community. I just want to contribute to the hygienic conditions of women in general. I don't have any other motive. It is totally for the cause of women. Actually, I took this initiative only to help you at first. But, then I thought why I shouldn't continue such things to benefit many others like you. All the experiments I am doing now are for that purpose only. Please understand and support me in my cause. I shall never give you a reason to feel bad.

I am waiting to see you back here. Please don't feel humiliated. I have a larger social cause. I just hope my dreams come true. I don't expect anything else.

I don't intend to write anything more as of now. Hope to see you soon.

Yours lovingly,

Bablu

12. News Report

The Padman of India: Conferred with Padma Shri

Staff Reporter

25 Oct 2025

Coimbatore: Mr. Arunachalam Muruganantham, popularly known as the *Padman of India*, has been conferred with the prestigious Padma Shri Award for the year 2016. He has been recognised for his dedicated efforts towards improving women's health and hygiene.

Mr. Arunachalam became well-known for his groundbreaking invention that enabled the production of affordable sanitary napkins. The low-cost machine he developed has greatly benefitted women across the country. His tireless experiments eventually led to a remarkable innovation that has had a significant impact on women's hygiene. Something that began as a humble initiative in a small town in Tamil Nadu soon gained nationwide attention. As a result, even rural and economically disadvantaged women can now afford sanitary napkins at a very reasonable price.

Receiving the Padma Shri, one of India's highest civilian honours, is a truly commendable achievement for Mr.Arunachalam. It stands as a well-deserved recognition of his social entrepreneurship and his commitment to empowering women.

14. Thoughts

How unfortunate is this! I never imagined that Gowri would leave me at such a critical moment. It has been my long-held dream to produce sanitary napkins that poor women can afford. As a woman, I expected Gowri to stand by me in this venture, but that did not happen. I cannot understand why my own family is opposing my experiment. I have endured immense stress and strain in gathering the right materials to make these napkins, yet society treats my work for women as a taboo. Although some of my initial attempts have failed, I still believe that one day I will succeed in creating the right product. In the meantime, I hope that Gowri's disagreement with me will be resolved.

15. Framing questions

1. Why was Bablu gloomy?
2. Did Bablu devise an idea to conduct experiments on him?
3. Who helped Bablu to collect blood?
4. What is the name of Parul's daughter?

16. Advertisement Jingles

Don't leave your home in dark
Let your home a shining spark

17. Advertisement Jingles

When the clouds begin to weep
Our umbrella is a promise to keep
When the sky is grey, don't you fret
We have got the best umbrellas yet.

The Seedling

A. **Read the lines from the poem *The Seedling* and answer the questions that follow.**

As a quiet little seedling
Lay within its darksome bed,
To itself it fell a-talking,
And this is what it said:
"I am not so very robust,
But I'll do the best I can;"
And the seedling from that moment
Its work of life began.

1. Where does the seedling lay?
2. How does the seedling's attitude reflect a message about personal growth or determination?
   A) It complains about the darkness.
   B) It waits for someone to help it.
   C) It decides to do its best despite its weakness.
   D) It refuses to grow until it feels ready.
3. What lesson or moral can we learn from the seedling's decision to "do the best I can"?
   A) Only strong people can succeed.
   B) Growth requires outside help.
   C) Giving up is sometimes necessary.
   D) A positive attitude can lead to growth and success.
4. What does the seedling say to itself?

B. Read the lines from the poem *The Seedling* and answer the questions that follow.

The leaflet liked the prospect,
So it called its brother, Stem;
Then two other leaflets heard it,
And quickly followed them.
To be sure, the haste and hurry
Made the seedling sweat and pant;
But almost before it knew it
It found itself a plant.

1. Why did the leaflet call its brother?
2. What does the phrase "sweat and pant" suggest about the seedling's experience?
   A) It was working hard and feeling tired.
   B) It found growth effortless.
   C) It was relaxing in the sun.
   D) It wanted to stop growing.
3. What message do the lines give you?
   A) Progress only happens when others help.
   B) Growth takes a very long time and is rarely noticed.
   C) Hard work and persistence lead to unexpected success.
   D) Only the strongest can grow.
4. What is the figure of speech used in the line "Made the seedling sweat and pant"

C. Read the following lines from the poem *The Seedling* and prepare an appreciation focusing on the poetic devices, theme and imagery.

As a quiet little seedling
Lay within its darksome bed,

To itself it fell a-talking,
And this is what it said:

"I am not so very robust,
But I'll do the best I can;"
And the seedling from that moment
Its work of life began.

So it pushed a little leaflet
Up into the light of day,
To examine the surroundings
And show the rest the way.

D. Read the following lines from the poem *The Seedling* by Paul Laurence Dunbar and *It Couldn't Be Done* by Edgar Albert Guest.

The Seedling	***It Couldn't Be Done***
Little folks, be like the seedling, Always do the best you can; Every child must share life's labour. Just as well as every man. And the sun and showers will help you. Through the lonesome, struggling hours, Till you rise to light and beauty Virtue's fair, unfading flowers.	There are thousands to tell you it cannot be done, There are thousands to prophesy failure, The dangers that wait to assail you. But just buckle in with a bit of a grin, Just take off your coat and go to it. Just start in to sing as you tackle the thing That "cannot be done," and you'll do it.

Both the poems have a hopeful, inspiring tone. Compare the two poems based on their theme, message, situation, and common elements.

The Seedling

ANSWERS

Comprehension – Textual Poem

A.

1. The seedling lay in the darksome bed.
2. C. It decides to do its best despite not being strong.
3. D. A positive attitude can lead to growth and success.
4. It says “I am not so very robust, but I’ll do the best I can”.

B.

1. The leaflet liked the prospect, so it called its brother stem to join.
2. A. It was working hard and feeling tired.
3. C. Hard work and persistence lead to unexpected success.
4. Personification

C. Appreciation -The Seedling

‘The Seedling’ is a beautiful poem written by Paul Lawrence Dunbar. The theme of the poem revolves around the importance of resilience and hard work in one’s life.

A tiny seedling immersed inside the dark soil has indeed immense potential. It speaks to itself and believes in its abilities very firmly. Although the seed knows it is brittle and not robust it asserts to do the best it could. This is where life begins. It is also obvious that during such a stage, we have to push a little harder. But, once it is done rest just follows. In fact, perseverance holds the key to success and resilience lies at the heart of the matter.

The poem is stanzaic in structure with four lines each. The rhyme scheme of the given stanzas is ab cb except the first. Alliteration could be seen in the phrase 'little leaflet' whereas personification can be seen in the line 'To itself it fell a- talking, And this is what it said'. Even visual imagery could be seen in the line 'As a quiet little seedling, lay within its darksome bed'.

The lines of the poem indeed suggest the immense potential of a seedling to rise grow and show the rest the way.

Language Elements

Reported Speech

A. Report the following dialogue.

1. Bablu : Why didn't you use the product I invented?

   Gowri : I found it annoying. It is disgusting too.

2. Mother : When will you stop your nonsense?

   Bablu: I will not stop until I am done. I am doing it for the sake of the women.

B. Report the following dialogue.

1. Srikanth : How can they deny me admission on such grounds?

   Teacher : Don't worry. We will get a clarification on it.

2. Srikanth : I am going to provide employment opportunities to the disabled individuals.

   Friend : Won't it be a problem for the company?

Editing

Edit the passage. Errors are given in bold.

1. Eventually, my parents and relatives **decide** (a) that I should study in a school **for** (b) students like me. So, I **had** (c) sent to a special school in Hyderabad. There I **exsceled** (d), becoming an outstanding student, earning top ranks, and representing **india** (e) in chess and cricket. I had **a** (f) privilege of working with Dr A.P.J. Abdul Kalam.

2. That evening **to** (a) his way back from the workshop, Bablu decided to surprise Gowri with a gift. He **gone** (b) to a small store. The store keeper quickly wrapped **an** (c) napkin packed in an old newspaper. Bablu was startled at the **exorbetent** (d) price, but dutifully paid him forty rupees. He unwrapped the packet **but** (e) examined the pad. It **seems** (f) to be just a plain cotton wrapped in a gauze sheet.

Cloze Type

Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the bracket.

1. Eventually, my parents ——(a)—— relatives decided ——(b)—— I should study in a school ——(c)—— students like me. So, I was sent ——(d)—— a special school ——(e)—— Hyderabad. There I excelled, becoming —(f)— outstanding student.

(to, an, and, with, that, in)

2. After six months ——(a)—— legal battle, I received a government order allowing me ——(b)—— study science, but at my own risk. Despite the lack of resources, I worked hard, ——(c)—— the help of ——(d)—— mentor. She recorded my textbooks ——(e)—— audio, and I scored 98% ——(f)—— my exams.

(with, on, of, in, to, a)

3. Bablu Kewat had been ——(a)—— indifferent student ——(b)—— best. He still remembers his science teacher Mrs Sharma, ——(c)—— the egg incubator that he had made ——(d)—— her supervision. But when Bablu's father died

leaving his mother struggling ——(e)—— support her small family, he dropped out ——(f)—— school to get a job and help her out.

(and, to, under, an, of, at)

4. He pulled ——(a)—— a pair ——(b)—— scissors, a needle ——(c)—— some thread, cotton and cloth ——(d)—— his bag. He began flattening the cotton ——(e)—— his hands as if he were spreading out dough ——(f)—— make a chapati.

(to, and, from, out, of, between)

Phrasal Verbs

Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

1. Srikanth decided that he will come back to India after his studies at the MIT. Since he had …….(a)…….. the problems of the disabled, he wanted to do something for them. He …….(b)……. Bollant Industries and made way for the employment of more than 150 disabled individuals. In fact, he …….(c)…… his personal dreams to do something for the underprivileged. His initiative ……...(d)……. a boon for them. His work is really commendable and the future generation will certainly ……(e)…… him with admiration.

[turn into, set up, look up to, figure out, give up, set out]

2. Bablu didn't want to ……(a)…….. to the flak he was receiving from the people. He had already made up his mind that he won't ……(b)…….. his dream. So, he …….(c)…… experimenting even though his wife and mother were against him. The efforts he …….(d)……. didn't go futile. Finally, his dedication ……(e)…….. when he made affordable napkins for women.

[put in, pay off, give in, go on, give up, get on]

Completion of Dialogue

1. **Complete the following conversation between Srikanth Bolla and his mentor.**

Mentor	:	Don't worry my dear. I shall help you.
Srikanth	:	……..…….(a)…….....?
Mentor	:	I will help you by recording the text for you.
Srikanth	:	I think it would be difficult for you, ...(b).....?
Mentor	:	No, It would never be difficult for me.
Srikanth	:	..... (c).....?
Mentor	:	No, it won't be time consuming.
Srikanth	:	If you support me, ... (d).....
Mentor	:	It is my dream to see you prospering.
Srikanth	:	The more support I get ……...(e)…….

2. **Complete the following conversation between Arunachalam Muruganantham and Shanti.**

Muruganantham	:	You really appreciate my attempts, ……(a).....?
Shanti	:	It's not really so.
Muruganantham	:	……..(b).....?
Shanti	:	You waste time on mad experiments.
Muruganantham	:	……(c).....?
Shanti	:	Yes. Our family faces disgrace by your sordid interest.
Muruganantham	:	But, Shanti, I am doing it with a good intention.

Shanti	:	If you continue with your nonsense, ……(d).....
Muruganantham	:	You had better ……..(e).....
Shanti	:	I cannot agree with everything you do.

Vocabulary

1. **Complete the sentences with the words given in brackets.**

(a) ..... Bablu had decided to go forward with his plans; there was no looking back.

(b) Srikanth had to move to MIT ..... he was denied admission at the IIT.

(though, as, because)

2. **Fill in the blanks using appropriate homonyms. The letters of the words have been jumbled in brackets.**

(a) The vacant spaces around the..... were used by the authorities to..... the vehicles. (k/p/a/r)

(b) It is.....on the part of parents to voice their concern over social injustice for their..... (i/g/r/t/h)

Unit 2

Language Elements

ANSWERS

A. Report the following dialogue.

1. Bablu asked Gowri why she hadn't used the product he had invented.
   Gowri replied that she had found it annoying and added that it was disgusting too.

2. Mother asked Bablu when he would stop his nonsense.
   Bablu replied that he would not stop until he was done and added that he was doing it for the sake of women.

B.

1. Srikanth asked the teacher how they could deny him admission on such grounds.
   The teacher advised Srikanth not to worry and added that they would get a clarification on it.
2. Srikanth said that he was going to provide employment opportunities to the disabled individuals.
   The friend asked Srikanth whether it wouldn't be a problem for the company.

Editing

1. (a) decided
   (b) with
   (c) was
   (d) excelled
   (e) India
   (f) the

1. (a) on
   (b) went
   (c) the
   (d) exorbitant
   (e) and
   (f) seemed

Cloze Type

1.	(a)	and	(b)	that
	(c)	with	(d)	to
	(e)	in	(f)	an
2.	(a)	of	(b)	to
	(c)	with	(d)	a
	(e)	on	(f)	in
3.	(a)	an	(b)	at
	(c)	and	(d)	under
	(e)	to	(f)	of
4.	(a)	out	(b)	of
	(c)	and	(d)	from
	(e)	between	(f)	to

Phrasal Verbs

1. (a) figured out
   (b) set up
   (c) gave up
   (d) turned into
   (e) look up to

2. (a) give in

   (b) give up

   (c) went on

   (d) put in

   (e) paid off

Completion of Dialogue

1. (a) How will you do it?

   (b) wouldn't it?

   (c) Won't it be time consuming?

   (d) I'll do my best.

   (e) the more confident I feel.

2. (a) don't you?

   (b) What makes you oppose me?

   (c) Do you feel our family faces disgrace by my sordid interest?

   (d) I will leave this house.

   (e) agree with my experiments

Vocabulary

1.

   (a) As

   (b) because

2.

   (a) park

   (b) right

Unit 3

THE TRUMPETS OF CHANGE

War

Comprehension – Textual Passage

A. Read the excerpt from *War* and answer the questions that follow.

The passengers who had left Rome by the night express had to stop until dawn at the small station of Fabriano. They then needed to continue their journey by the old-fashioned local train to Sulmona.

At dawn, in a stuffy and smoky second class carriage in which a few people had already spent the night, a stout woman in deep mourning was hoisted in. Behind her, puffing and moaning, followed her husband—a tiny man, thin and weak, his face death-white. His eyes were small and bright and he looked shy and uneasy.

Having at last taken a seat, he politely thanked the passengers who had helped his wife by making room for her. Then he turned round to the woman and politely inquired:

"Are you all right, dear?"

The wife, instead of answering, pulled up the collar of her coat to hide her face.

"Nasty world," muttered the husband with a sad smile.

1. Why did the passengers stop at Fabriano till dawn?
2. Describe the physical appearance of the husband.
3. What kind of dress was the woman wearing?
   A) Colourful
   B) Very old
   C) Mourning
   D) Foreign

4. What do you infer about the emotional state of the stout woman?

   A) She was angry.

   B) She was in grief.

   C) She was full of hatred.

   D.) She was proud.

5. Identify the **Noun phrase** in the subject position and the **Verb phrase** from the sentence given below:

   His eyes were small and bright and he looked shy and uneasy.

B. Read the excerpt from *War* and answer the questions that follow.

She lifted her head and bent over from her corner. She was trying to listen with great attention to the details which the stout man was giving to his companions. He was telling them the way his son had fallen as a hero, for his Country, happy and without regrets. It seemed to her that she had stumbled into a world so far unknown to her. And she was so pleased to hear everyone joining in congratulating that brave father, so stoically speaking of his child's death.

Then suddenly, as if waking up from a dream, she turned to the old man, asking him:

"Then…is your son really dead?"

Everyone stared at her. The old man, too, turned to look at her. He fixed his great, bulging, horribly watery eyes, deep in her face. For some time he tried to answer, but words failed him. He looked and looked at her. It was as if only then, at that silly, incongruous question— he had suddenly realised at last that his son was really dead—gone for ever—for ever. His face contracted and became horribly distorted. Then he snatched in haste a handkerchief from his pocket and, to the amazement of everyone, broke into harrowing, heart-breaking, uncontrollable sobs.

1. What was the stout man talking about?

2. Which word in the passage means 'to suffer without complaining or showing emotion'?
   A) Stoically
   B) Incongruous
   C) Distorted
   D) Harrowing

3. What makes the man realise his real feelings?

4. The old man's _____ reveals his true feelings.
   A) Courage
   B) Brave words
   C) Sobs
   D) Watery eyes

5. According to the passage given above, how does war affect the common man?

Discourses (7 Marks)

1. Luigi Pirandello, in the story *War* vividly portrays the plight of parents who lost their sons in the war front. It also presents a realistic picture of the misery and the meaninglessness of war even today. Based on your reading, prepare a **review** of the story.

   [Hints: journey by local train to Sulmona - stout woman in deep mourning - followed by her husband – passengers share their experiences – lost sons in the war front – different views on war – a passenger upholds nationalism – opined that children belong to the country – love for one's country is greater than that

for one's children – country is a natural necessity – passengers astonished - brave father – woman's question – man bursts out into tears]

3. Whatever may be the cause, the effect of war is never soothing to the victims as Luigi Pirandello's story *War* portrays it. Imagine you are asked to deliver a speech in the school assembly, on the topic, "War – A Curse to Mankind". Write the script of the **speech**.

   [Consequences of war – loss of life and property – shattered families – sufferings – destruction – importance of peace)

3. The story *War* reveals the fact that the pain of losing a loved one is too deep to hide. The love for family is a universal feeling. Write an **article** on the emotional impact of war based on your reading the story.

Discourses (6 marks)

4. In the story *War* by Luigi Pirandello, the stout old man shows exemplary patience and attitude in hiding his emotions before breaking down with uncontrollable sobs. Prepare a **character sketch** of the stout man on the basis of your reading the story.

5. The story *War* by Luigi Pirandello may be a haunting one for us. Moreover, no one was able to console the mother who was at the brink of losing her only son at the war front. Draft an **email** to your friend sharing your thoughts about the sad mother.

6. Prepare a **profile** of Phil Collins using the hints given below.

   Name : Philip David Charles Collins

   Nick name : Little Elvis

   Born : January 30, 1951, London England.

Parents	:	Greville Philip Austin Collins, Winifred June Collins
Famous as	:	Drummer, Singer, Song writer.
Rock Band	:	Genesis
First solo song	:	In the Air Tonight
Other Hits	:	Another Day in Paradise, Against All Odds, One More Night.
Achievements	:	Grammy Awards (8 times), Golden Globe (2 times), Academy Award, Disney Legend Award.

7. "Parental love is not like bread that can be broken into pieces,..." says Luigi Pirandello in his touching story, *War*. Using the ideas from the story along with your own views, prepare a **paragraph** on parental love.

8. The stout man in the story, *War* tried to control his emotions only to break down at the end with uncontrollable sobs. He is unable to bear the sad reality of having lost his son. Attempt the **diary entry** of the stout man.

9. When the stout man interrupted the heated discussion, all the travellers stared at him in distress. But they were all amazed when he broke out in tears at the end. Imagine two travellers of the train converse about the incident later. Prepare the likely **conversation** between them.

10. In connection with the anti - war campaign, the Arts Club of your school has decided to conduct an exhibition on 21 September, the International Day of Peace. Being the secretary of the club, draft a **notice** with all necessary details to be put up on the notice board.

11. Read the passage given below and **frame four appropriate questions** based on it.

And he felt it his duty to explain to his travelling companions that the poor woman was to be pitied. The war was taking away from her their only son, a boy of twenty. Both of them had devoted their entire life to him. They had even broken up their home at Sulmona to follow him to Rome, where he had to go as a student. They allowed him to volunteer for war with an assurance that for at least six months he would not be sent to the war front. And now, all of a sudden, they received a wire from him saying that he was due to leave in three days' time. They were now going to see him off.

War

ANSWERS

Comprehension - Textual Passage

A .

1. The passengers stopped at Fabriano till dawn to continue their journey by the old-fashioned local train to Sulmona.
2. The husband was a tiny man, thin and weak and his face was death-white. He also had small bright eyes.
3. C. Mourning
4. B. She was in grief.
5. Noun phrase: His eyes
   Verb phrase: were small and bright and he looked shy and uneasy

B.

1. The stout man was talking about his son.
2. A. Stoically
3. The woman's question "then…. is your son really dead" makes the man realise his real feelings.
4. C. Sobs
5. Ordinary people live heartbroken at the time of war. They are shattered by the loss of near and dear ones.

5. Email

From: [Sender's email id]

To: [Recipient's email id]

Subject: Thoughts on the Mother in Luigi Pirandello's War

Dear [Friend's Name],

I just finished reading Luigi Pirandello's short story War, and I cannot stop thinking about the mother in it. Her silent suffering is truly haunting. While the other parents try to comfort themselves by saying that their sons belong to the nation and that personal sacrifice is part of war, the mother remains speechless.

She is at the brink of losing her only son at the war front, and no words seem strong enough to console her. What struck me deeply is that the grief of a mother cannot be reasoned away by patriotism or philosophy. Her love is pure and unconditional, and the fear of losing her child is greater than any sense of duty to the country.

Pirandello portrays her pain with such intensity that it makes us realize how war is not just about soldiers on the battlefield, but also about the silent suffering of families left behind. The image of the mother, unable to accept the harsh reality, continues to echo in my mind. It reminds me that war, in the end, brings more sorrow than glory.

I feel this story is a powerful reminder of the human cost of war and the depth of a mother's love. What do you think about her silence and the way the story ends?

Looking forward to hearing your thoughts.

Warm regards,

[Your Name]

6. Profile

Phil Collins

One of the famous British singers Philip David Charles Collins is a name to reckon with in the world of music. His rock band Genesis has also made a name for itself. He was born to Greville Philip Austin Collins and Winifred June Collins on January 30 1951 at London in England. Being named as Philip David Charles Collins,

he also has a nickname a Little Elvis. Phil Collins is not only a singer but also a drummer and a song writer. The first solo song sung by the great singer is In the Air Tonight. He continued his singing to give us some other hits like Another Day in Paradise, Against All Odds and One More Night. The famous singer has quite a few achievements to his credit. He has won Grammy award eight times, the Golden Globe twice, Academy Award and the Disney Legend Award.

Any music lover will definitely remember the name, since Phil Collins has made a mark for himself in the hearts of the people.

7. Paragraph

Unparallel Love

Luigi Pirandello, in his touching story *War*, says, "Parental love is not like bread that can be broken into pieces," reminding us that a parent's love cannot be shared in small parts or reduced in any way. Every child receives a parent's whole heart. In the story, the parents who have sent their children to the battlefield carry a quiet, unbearable pain within them. On the outside they try to look strong, but inside they are filled with fear, worry, and the longing to hold their children close again. Pirandello beautifully shows that parental love does not fade with time. It stays the same even when children grow up, make mistakes, or face dangers far away from home. This love gives children comfort, courage, and the feeling that they always have someone to rely on. Parents guide their children with care, make countless sacrifices, and constantly pray for their safety and happiness. The story gently reminds us that a parent's love is a powerful and unbreakable bond—whole, deep, and impossible to divide—because every child occupies a unique and irreplaceable place in a parents' heart.

10.

NOTICE

G B International School

Thrissur

Art Exhibition

Dear students,

The Arts Club of our school has decided to conduct an ***Art Exhibition*** in connection with the ongoing anti-war campaign to mark the International Day of Peace. The main theme of the exhibition is peace, harmony and global unity.

Colonel J B Rawat (Retd) has consented to inaugurate the exhibition.

Date: September 21, 2026

Time: 9 a.m. to 2 p.m.

Venue: School Auditorium

We urge all students to participate and make this event a meaningful one.

Thrissur
10.09.2026

Sd/
Secretary
Arts Club

Programme Details

Prayer	:	School Choir
Welcome Address	:	Head Master
Presidential Address	:	PTA President
Inauguration & Keynote address	:	Colonel J B Rawat (Retd)
Felicitation	:	Staff Secretary
Peace Pledge	:	School Leader
Vote of thanks	:	Secretary, Arts Club

11. Framing questions

1. What did the husband explain to his travelling companions?

2. How old was the only son of the couple?

3. Why did the couple break up their home at Sulmona?

4. Had the parents allowed their son to volunteer for war?

A Piece of String

Comprehension – Textual Passage

A. Read the excerpt from *A Piece of String* and answer the questions that follow.

Along all the roads around Goderville, the peasants and their wives were coming to the town because it was market day. Some led a cow or a calf by a cord, and their wives, walking behind the animal, whipped it with a leafy branch to hasten its progress. In the public square of Goderville, there was a crowd, a throng of human beings and animals.

Hauchecome had just arrived at Goderville, and he was walking towards the public square. Then he saw a little piece of string on the ground. He thought that everything useful ought to be picked up. He took the bit of thin cord from the ground and began to roll it carefully. Then he noticed Malandain, on the threshold of his door, looking at him. They were on bad terms with each other. Hauchecome was seized with shame to be seen thus by his enemy. He concealed his find quickly in his trousers pocket. He pretended to be looking on the ground for something else. Then, he went towards the market.

1. Why were the peasants and their wives coming to the town?
2. What prompted the peasant to pick the little piece of string from the ground?

3. Why were the cattle whipped by the wives on the way?

   A) To hamper their movement.

   B) To stop their movement.

   C) To hasten their movement.

   D) To avoid their movement.

Choose the correct option.

i. A and C

ii. B and D

iii. Only C

iv. Only B

4. How did Hauchcome feel, when he knew he was being watched by his enemy?

A) He felt proud.

B) He felt nervous.

C) He felt ashamed.

D) He felt confident.

5. Pick out a word from the passage which means 'the entrance to a building or room'.

B. Read the excerpt from *A Piece of String* and answer the questions that follow.

The next day about one o'clock in the afternoon, an employee in a shop returned the pocket book. The man claimed to have found the object in the road. Not knowing how to read, he had given it to his employer.

The news spread through the neighborhood. Hauchcome was informed of it. He immediately began to recount his story with its happy climax. He was in triumph. He talked of his adventure all day long. He told it on the highway to people who were passing by, in the wine shop to people who were drinking there and two persons coming out of church the following Sunday. He stopped strangers to tell them about it.

He was calm now, and yet something disturbed him. People had the air of joking while they listened. They did not seem convinced. He seemed to feel that remarks were being made behind his neck.

1. Where did the employee find the pocket book?

2. Why did Hauchcome stop the strangers?

3. Who hadn't been told the story by the protagonist?

A) People at the railway station.

B) People in the wine shop.

C) People coming out of church.

D) People on the way.

4. Pick out the word from the passage which means 'a great victory or achievement'.

5. Why was Hachecome disturbed even after telling his story to many people?

Discourses – 7 Marks

1. The story, *A Piece of String* by Guy de Maupassant depicts the pain of being falsely accused. Based on your reading of the story prepare a **review** focusing on its characterisation, theme and plot development.

   (Hints: market day in Goderville — Hauchecome finds a little piece of string— Malandain notices — conceals his find— pocketbook missing — doubt falls on Hauchecome — tries to prove his innocence — no one believes—yields to death unable to prove his innocence.)

Discourses – 6 Marks

2. Hauchecome tries hard to convince the Mayor of his innocence at his office. He returns home dejected and narrates his experience at the Mayor's office to his wife. Attempt the likely **narrative**.

3. After Hauchcome's death, his wife couldn't help but write a letter to one of her friends, mentioning the mental trauma her husband had gone through and the Mayor's role in it. Prepare the likely **letter**.

4. Prepare a **profile** of Guy De Maupassant using the following hints.

Birth	:	August 5, 1850 near Dieppe,France
Famous as	:	Greatest French short story writer
Literary debut	:	Boule de Suif (1880)
Notable works	:	La Maison Tellier (1881), Une Vie (1883), Bel-Ami (1885)
Legacy	:	works are thoroughly realistic, objectively presents men and women, satiric techniques are used
Death	:	July 6, 1893 (aged 42)

5. Hauchecome, the central character in the story *A Piece of String* had undergone the worst situations in his life when he was misunderstood by others. It was quite unfortunate that he couldn't prove himself before his death. Based on the reading of the story, prepare a **character sketch** of Hauchecome.

Discourses – 4 Marks

6. Even after the pocketbook was recovered, nobody was ready to believe Mr. Hauchecome's story. He was stricken to the heart by the injustice of suspicion. What might be his feelings then? Write his **diary entry**.

7. Hauchecome is accused of stealing the pocketbook and is summoned by the Mayor to appear before him for an enquiry. Write the possible **conversation** between them.

8. In the story *'A Piece of String'* Hauchecome dies in shame and humiliation because of the indifferent attitude of society. Prepare a **paragraph** on the way the attitude of the society impacts people.

9. Read the passage given below and **frame four appropriate questions** based on it.

Suddenly the drum beat in the courtyard outside the tavern. Everybody rose, except a few, and ran to the door or to the windows, their mouths still full. After the public crier had ceased his drumbeating, he called out in a jerky voice: "This is hereby made known to the inhabitants of Goderville, and to all persons present at the market: There was lost this morning on the road, between nine and ten o'clock, a black leather pocketbook containing five hundred francs and some business papers. The finder is requested to return the same with all haste to the Mayor's office. There will be twenty francs reward."

A Piece of String

ANSWERS

Comprehension - Textual Passage

A.

1. The peasants and their wives were coming to the town because it was market day.
2. The peasant picked the little piece of string because he thought that everything useful ought to be picked up.
3. iii Only C
4. C. He felt ashamed.
5. threshold

B.

1. The employee found the pocket book in the road.
2. Hauchcome stopped the strangers to recount his story with its happy climax.
3. A. people at the railway station
4. triumph
5. Hauchecome felt disturbed because the people were not convinced by his story.

Discourses – Sample Answers

1. Review

'A Piece of String' is a very touching and thought provoking short story written by the French author Guy de Maupassant who is celebrated as a master of short story. The story is set in Goderville. Among the characters portrayed in the story, Hauchecome, a peasant, Malandain, Hauchecome's rival and a Mayor are the prominent ones. This story explores the themes of reputation, social judgement and the destructive power of rumours.

The narrative revolves around Hauchecome, an elderly peasant who is falsely accused of stealing a pocketbook after picking up a piece of string in the market place. When Malandain, his enemy sees him picking up the string Hauchecome quickly hides

the string in his trousers' pocket. Later, a pocket book is reported missing in the town. Malandain takes advantage of the situation and lies to the Mayor and accuses Hauchecome of taking it. Hauchecome furiously denies the accusations even showing them the string he picked up. But no one believes his version of the story. Even when the real pocketbook was found and returned by someone else the people were not ready to accept his innocence. Despite his protests and evidence they refuse to believe him which ultimately leads to his downfall.

The story highlights how quickly rumours can spread and damage someone's reputation. The villagers' readiness to judge Hauchecome based on his past disgrace reputation and a trivial action showcases the harsh nature of small-town life. The story also highlights the flaws in the justice system and societal norms. Maupassant criticises the human tendency to believe the worst about others and the destructive power of gossip. The realistic portrayal of rural life adds depth to the story making the characters and events more relatable.

Overall 'A Piece of String' is a masterful tale that explores the complexities of human nature and the devastating consequences of unchecked rumours and social judgement.

2. Narrative

I had a horrible time at the Mayor's office today. However hard I tried, I couldn't convince the Mayor. Why do people behave like this? It's disgusting indeed. Don't you want to know what happened? Let me tell you.

When I was at the tavern, the chief of the gendarmes summoned me to the Mayor's office. I couldn't resist and obliged. I accompanied him and reached the Mayor's office. To my surprise, the Mayor accused me of picking the lost pocketbook. I told him that I hadn't picked any pocketbook but he was not ready to accept it. Instead I confessed that I had picked up only a piece of string from the road, which was lying on the way. The Mayor told me that our neighbour Malandain had been the witness to my picking up the pocketbook. Actually, he was there looking at me when I was picking the piece of string. But, I don't know how Malandain made the Mayor believe that I had

picked the pocketbook. Whatever it is, I didn't have any answers either. I even agreed to be searched upon for any proof whatsoever. Finally, when the Mayor didn't find anything, I was let off.

I just felt so helpless. Nobody took my side and I was humiliated. I felt victimised too. I told many people on the way back, but who cares. Anyways, I believe you would understand me, at least. In fact, it was a terrible experience indeed.

7. Conversation

Mayor : Mr Hauchecome, did you pick up the pocketbook?

Hauchecome : No. I haven't, your honour.

Mayor : But you were seen on the road this morning.

Hauchecome : Who saw me?

Mayor : Mr Malandain, the harness maker.

Hauchecome : He saw me pick up this string.

Mayor : But he said that you have picked up the pocketbook.

Hauchecome : I swear my honour! It was only a piece of string.

Mayor : Malandain is a man of credit. He won't lie.

Hauchecome : He lies over this honest peasant.

Mayor : Then, where is the pocket book?

Hauchecome : How do I know?

Mayor : You may go now. But, I don't believe you.

Hauchecome : Oh god! I am being ruined for a simple worthless string.

9. Framing Questions

1. Where was the drum beat heard?
2. What was lost on the road?
3. What did the pocket book contain?
4. Did he announce any reward for the finder?

Another Day in Paradise

Comprehension - Textual Poem/Song

A. Read the lines from the song *Another Day in Paradise* and answer the questions that follow.

She calls out to the man on the street
"Sir, can you help me?
It's cold and I've nowhere to sleep
Is there somewhere you can tell me?"
He walks on, doesn't look back
He pretends he can't hear her
Starts to whistle as he crosses the street
Seems embarrassed to be there.
Oh, think twice, cause it's another day for
You and me in paradise.
Oh, think twice, cause it's another day for you,
You and me in paradise
Think about it

1. What is the real need of the woman?

2. How does the man on the street respond to the woman's call?

   A) He helps her.
   B) He pretends he can't hear.
   C) He walks on.
   D) He looks back

Choose the correct option.

   i. B and C

ii. Only A

iii. All

iv. A and B

3. How do you interpret ‘Paradise’ in the context of the song?

A) The dwelling place of the God.

B) The dwelling place of the commuter.

C) The dwelling place of the comfortable and fortunate people.

D) A place of agony and stress.

4. Identify the poetic device used in the line ‘He pretends he can’t hear her’

B. Read the lines from the song *Another Day in Paradise* and answer the questions that follow.

She calls out to the man on the street,
He can see she’s been crying,
She’s got blisters on the soles of her feet
She can’t walk but she’s trying
Oh, think twice, cause it’s just another day for you,
You and me in paradise.
Oh, think twice, cause it’s just another day for you,
You and me in paradise.
Just think about it.

1. Whom does the woman call out for help?

A) The woman on the street.

B) The man on the street.

C) The man in the shop.

D) The woman in the shop.

2. Why has the lady been crying?

3. Which is the poetic device used in the line, "She's got blisters on the soles of her feet"?

   A) Simile

   B) Refrain

   C) Visual image

   D) Anaphora

4. Who does the singer addresses as 'You' in the given lines?

C. Read the following lines from the poem *Another day in Paradise* and prepare a note of appreciation focusing on the theme, techniques and literary devices.

She calls out to the man on the street.
"Sir, can you help me?
It's cold and I've nowhere to sleep,
Is there somewhere you can tell me?"
He walks on, doesn't look back
He pretends he can't hear her
Starts to whistle as he crosses the street
Seems embarrassed to be there.
Oh, think twice, cause it's another day for
You and me in paradise.
Oh, think twice, cause it's another day for you
You and me in paradise,
Think about it.

D. Read the given lines from the songs *Another Day in Paradise* and *Man on the Corner* by Phil Collins which deal with the theme of the plight of the homeless and the indifference of society towards them.

Another Day in Paradise	*Man on the Corner*
She calls out to the man on the street	He‘s a lonely man, there on the corner
"Sir, can you help me?	What his waiting for, I don’t know
It's cold and I've nowhere to sleep,	But he waits everyday now
Is there somewhere you can tell me?"	He’s just waiting for something to show, oh
He walks on, doesn't look back	Nobody knows him
He pretends he can't hear her	And Nobody cares
Starts to whistle as he crosses the street	‘Cause there’s no hiding place
Seems embarrassed to be there.	There’s no hiding place

Write a **paragraph** on how these two songs explore the themes of loneliness and the attitude of the people to ignore the homeless.

Another Day in Paradise

ANSWERS

Comprehension - Textual Poem

A. 1. The real need of the woman is a safe place to sleep.

2. i. B and C

3. C. The dwelling place of comfortable and fortunate people.

4. Alliteration

B.

1. B) The man on the street.

2. The lady has been crying because she has got blisters on the soles of her feet.

3. C) Visual image

4. The listeners.

C. Appreciation - Another Day in Paradise

The song 'Another Day in Paradise' is one among the successful singles of the British musician, singer, song-writer, record producer and actor, Philip Collins. It is a poignant commentary on homelessness and social apathy.

A woman in the street calls out to a passerby and enquires him if he can tell her a place where she can shelter herself from the cold. He pretends he can't hear her and crosses the street with a whistle of negligence. People who have the privilege to lead a happy life are in paradise. They can pretend to be deaf and dumb. The woman is in tears as the blisters on her soles hinder her when she tries to walk. The woman has been walking from one place to another as she didn't fit in there. Lines of fatigue are visible on her face. The lucky people who are gifted with a blessed life choose to look away when she seeks help. This song depicts how society ignores the struggles of those who live in the streets. The central theme of the song is societal indifference shown to the poor and the homeless.

The title of the poem itself is an irony as it contrasts the comfortable life of many with the harsh realities faced by the homeless. The imagery used in the lyrics paint a

vivid picture of the homeless woman's struggles with lines like "She calls out to the man in the street"; "Sir, can you help me?". The comparison of the world to "paradise" is a metaphor that highlights the contrast between the haves and have-nots. The repeated refrain "Oh, think twice, cause it's another day for you and me in paradise." serves as a moral reminder to consider the consequences of our actions. The song alludes to the idea that we are all responsible for our fellow human beings and that we should not turn blind eye to suffering.

The homeless woman can be seen as a symbol for all those who are struggling and marginalised in society. This song presented in a story telling style contrasts between comfort and desperation.

Language Elements

Reported Speech

A. Report the following dialogue.

1. Officer : Will you accompany me to the Mayor's office?
   Hauchecome : Yes, of course. I will accompany you.
2. Hauchecome : How embarrassing it is to be victimised!
   Villager : Why didn't you prove your innocence?

B. Report the following dialogue.

1. Passenger : I have two sons and three nephews at the front.
   Husband : Maybe. But in our case, it is our only son.
2. Stout man : Do we give life to our children for our own benefit?
   Passenger : No. Our children do not belong to us, rather they belong to the country.

Editing

Edit the passage. Errors are given in bold.

1. The woman was twisting and **wregling** (a), at times growling like **an** (b) wild animal. She **feel** (c) certain that all those explanations would not have **arouse** (d)

even a shadow of sympathy from those people. They were all, most **like** (e) in the same plight as **himself** (f).

2. Then the man **go** (a) away and the **peseants** (b) began to talk of this event. They discussed the chances of finding **and** (c) not finding the pocket book. They **are** (d) finishing their coffee **where** (e) a chief of **an** (f) gendarmes appeared.

Cloze Type

Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the bracket.

1. The passengers who had left Rome ——(a)—— the night express had to stop ——(b)—— dawn at the small station ——(c)—— Fabriano. They then had to continue their journey by the old-fashioned local train ——(d)—— Sulmona. ……(e)…… dawn, in a stuffy and smoky second class carriage in which a few people had already spent the night, a stout woman —— (f)—— deep mourning was hoisted in.

(from, by, until, of, in, to, at)

2. The war was taking away ——(a)—— her their only son, a boy ——(b)—— twenty. Both of them had devoted their entire life ——(c)—— him. They had even broken ——(d)—— their home ——(e)—— Sulmona to follow him to Rome, —— (f) —— he had to go as a student.

(up, at, from, where, of, to)

3. Along all the roads —(a)— Goderville, the peasants —(b)— their wives were coming —(c)— the town because it was market day. Some led a cow or a calf —(d)— a cord, and their wives, walking —(e)— the animal, whipped it with —(f)—- leafy branch to hasten its progress.

(behind, to, and, around, a, by)

4. The news spread ——(a)—— the neighbourhood. Hauchecome was informed of it. He immediately began ——(b)—— recount his story ——(c)—— its

happy climax. He was ——(d)—— triumph. He talked ——(e)—— his adventure all day long. He told it ——(f)—— the highway to people who were passing by.

(with, to, through, on, of, in)

Phrasal Verbs

Complete the paragraph using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in brackets.

1. The wife was not able to__(a)__her feelings to anyone. The husband even explained everything to his travelling companions. Actually, they had __(b)__everything to__(c)__their son. When they allowed him to volunteer for war they had __(d)__a condition. Even though they__(e)__a strong resistance they had to send their son to the war front.

   [put aside, put across, put forward, bring up, put up, put off]

2. Hauchecome ……(a)…….. the Mayor at his office, being summoned for an enquiry. There, he tried to ……..(b)…… his views. But, the Mayor insisted that he prove his innocence. He ……(c)……. explaining but it was futile. He even consented to be searched. At last, he even …….(d)…… of options. Finally immensely depressed, he ……(e)…….. of the Mayor's office back to his house.

   [go on, put across, run out, call on, set out, put up]

Completion of Dialogue

1. Complete the following conversation between one of the travellers on the train and the husband from the story *War*.

Traveller : Your son hasn't yet left for the war front, ...(a).....?

Husband : He will be leaving in three days.

Traveller : ……(b).....?

Husband : We received a wire from him.

Traveller : If you go there, ... (c).....?

Husband	:	No, we cannot stop him, we can just see him leave.
Traveller	:	……(d).....?
Husband	:	We want to see him leave to the war front because he is our only son.
Traveller	:	Then would you mind ……(e).....
Husband	:	Yes, I shall control my emotions.

2. Complete the conversation between the Mayor and Hauchecome.

Mayor	:	You have taken the pocketbook, …….(a)…….
Hauchecome	:	No, I haven't taken it.
Mayor	:	……(b)…….
Hauchecome	:	I picked up only a piece of string from the road.
Mayor	:	I don't believe you. If you don't return the pocketbook, …….(c)……
Hauchecome	:	Please don't be so cruel. I'm innocent.
Mayor	:	……(d)…….?
Hauchecome	:	No, I'm not trying to cheat you.
Mayor	:	You had better ……..(e)……
Hauchecome	:	I won't admit that I have taken the pocketbook.

<u>Vocabulary</u>

1. Fill in the blanks using appropriate words chosen from those given in the bracket.

a. The pocket book was ..... (either /neither) taken by Hauchecome nor seen by Malandain.

b. Neither the lady nor the passengers.....(was/were) ready to come to terms.

2. Fill in the blanks using appropriate tense forms given in the bracket.

a. Hauchecome …… to convince the people of his innocence since the day he was falsely accused. (have been trying/had been trying)

b. The passengers …… about their children, who have been sent to the war front. (has been talking/have been talking)

Unit 3

Language Elements

ANSWERS

Reported Speech

A.

1. The Officer requested Hauchecome whether he would accompany him to the Mayor's office.

   Hauchecome asserted and said that he would accompany him.

2. Hauchecome exclaimed that it was embarrassing to be victimised.

   The Villager asked Hauchecome why he hadn't proved his innocence.

B.

1. The passenger told the husband that he had two sons and three nephews at the front.

   The husband replied that it might be so but said that in their case it was their only son.

2. The stout man asked the passenger whether they gave life to their children for their own benefit.

   The passenger replied negatively and added that their children did not belong to them rather they belonged to the country.

Editing

1. (a) wriggling
   (b) a
   (c) felt
   (d) aroused
   (e) likely
   (f) herself

2. (a) went
   (b) peasants

(c) or

(d) were

(e) when

(f) the

Cloze Type

1. (a) by (b) until
   (c) of (d) to
   (e) At (f) in

2. (a) from (b) of
   (c) to (d) up
   (e) at (f) where

3. (a) around (b) and
   (c) to (d) by
   (e) behind (f) a

4. (a) through (b) to
   (c) with (d) in
   (e) of (f) on

Phrasal Verbs

1. (a) put across

   (b) put aside

   (c) bring up

   (d) put forwarded

   (e) put up

2. (a) called on

(b) put across

(c) went on

(d) ran out

(e) set out

Completion of Dialogue

1. (a) has he?

(b) How did you know that he is leaving?

(c) will you be able to stop him?

(d) Why do you want to see him leave to the war front?

(e) controlling your emotions.

2. (a) haven't you?

(b) What did you pick up from the road?

(c) I will punish you.

(d) Are you trying to cheat me?

(e) admit that you have taken the pocketbook.

Vocabulary

1. (a) neither

(b) were

2. (a) had been trying

(b) have been talking

Unit 4

Woodland Whispers

Shakuntalam

Comprehension – Textual passage

A. Read the following excerpt from *Shakuntalam* and answer the questions that follow.

KING: Charioteer, the deer has led us a long chase.

And even now
His neck in beauty bends
As backward looks he sends
At my pursuing car
That threatens death from far.
Fear shrinks to half the body small;
See how he fears the arrow's fall!
The path he takes is strewed
With blades of grass half chewed
He leaps so often and so high,
He does not seem to run, but fly.
Pursue as I may, I can hardly keep him in sight.

CHARIOTEER: Your Majesty, I have been holding the
horses back because the ground was rough. This gave
the deer a lead. Now we are on level ground, and you will
easily overtake him.

1. What does the deer do as he looks back at the pursuing chariot?

2. What emotion does the King observe in the deer while it was trying to escape?

A) Fear
B) Anger
C) Joy
D) Curiosity

3. Why does the Charioteer say the deer seems not to run but fly?

4. What is the Charioteer's contention of holding the horses back?

A) The terrain was not rough.
B) The terrain was even.
C) The terrain was rough.
D) The terrain was slippery.

5. Pick the word from the excerpt that means 'to be spread in an untidy way over a surface'.

B. Read the following excerpt from *Shākuntalam* and answer the questions that follow.

SHAKUNTALA : Oh, girls, that mango tree is trying to tell me something with his branches that move in the wind like fingers. I must go and see him.

(she does so)

PRIYAMVADA : There Shakuntala, stand right where your are a minute.

SHAKUNTALA : Why?

PRIYAMVADA : When I see you there, it looks as if a vine were clinging to the mango tree.

ANASUYA : Oh Shakuntala! Here is the jasmine vine that you named Light of the Grove. She has chosen the mango tree as her husband!

SHAKUNTALA : What a pretty pair they make! The jasmine shows her youth in her fresh flowers, and the mango tree shows his strength in his ripening fruit.

1. What makes Shakuntala feel that the mango tree is trying to tell her something?
2. How does Priyamvada describe the sight of Shakuntala standing near the mango tree?
3. What name did Shakuntala give to the jasmine vine?
   A) Queen of the Forest
   B) Fragrance of the Grove
   C) Light of the Grove
   D) Beauty of the Garden
4. How does Shakuntala describe the jasmine and the mango tree together?
   A) As a pretty pair showing youth and strength.
   B) As an odd combination.
   C) As rivals for sunlight.
   D) As a sad sight in the forest.
5. Identify the **Noun Phrase** in the subject position and the **Prepositional Phrase** from the sentence given below.

   The mango tree shows his strength in his ripening fruit.

Discourse (7 Marks)

1. King Dushyanta's behaviour undergoes a great transformation upon entering the vicinity of the hermitage. Prepare a **review** of the act 'The Hunt' from the play *Shakuntalam* highlighting the themes of blissful coexistence with nature, duty and love.

   [Hints: King Dushyanta chases a deer - hermits warn him - he follows the words of the hermits – King likes the sanctity of the grove - the animals are cared with love – plants are treated as living beings - King Dushyanta could sense love, compassion and care in the hermitage]

2. The peaceful living among the beings in the hermitage is highlighted in the act 'The Hunt' from *Shakuntalam*. How does it stand universal and relevant even today? Prepare a **write-up** on the importance of harmonious living in nature based on the reading of the above excerpt.

   [Hints: Hunting of deer – warning of hermits – hunting abandoned – beauty of hermitage – peaceful living – self realisation of King Dushyanta – harmonious living – no space for enmity – peace and happiness]

Discourse (6 Marks)

3. King Dushyanta enters the hermitage of Sage Kanva and transforms himself after meeting the inmates there. It is evident from his mannerisms that he has good aesthetic sense and is humble too. Prepare the **character sketch** of King Dushyanta based on your reading of the act, 'The Hunt' from *Shakuntalam*.

4. King Dushyanta's hunt for the deer ends up in the realisation of the fact that man can live peacefully even without disturbing the balance of nature. **Narrate** the episode of Dushyanta and the deer in your own words based on the reading of the act, 'The Hunt' from *Shakuntalam.*

5. Prepare a short **profile** of Arthur William Ryder using the hints given below.

Born	:	March 8, 1877, Oberlin, Ohio, U.S
Education	:	School Education from Ann Arbor, Michigan
		Graduation from Phillips Academy, Massachusetts
		Doctor of Philosophy from University of Leipzig

Occupation	:	Professor of Sanskrit at the University of California Instructor in Sanskrit at Harvard University Translated a number of Sanskrit works into English
Major works of Translation	:	Sudraka's Mṛcchakatika, Kālidāsa's Abhijñānaśākuntalam, Meghadoota, Bhagavad Gita, The Panchatantra
Death	:	March 21, 1938.

Discourse (4 Marks)

6. King Dushyanta decides not to kill the deer and places the arrow back in his quiver. He realises his mistake and talks to the charioteer about it. Attempt the likely **conversation** between them.

7. King Dushyanta places the arrow back in the quiver after he realises that it is his duty to protect rather than harm. Attempt the likely **diary entry** of King Dushyanta compiling his thoughts of self realisation.

8. Harmonious living is the need of the time as well. Don't you agree? Write a short **paragraph** on how we could live harmoniously with other beings amidst nature based on the reading of the act, The Hunt from *Shakuntalam.*

9. The English Club of your school decides to stage the play Shankuntalam as part of the Drama Fest in your school. Being the secretary of the club, draft a **notice** with all necessary details to be circulated in school.

10. Shakuntala always felt like a real sister to the trees in the hermitage and looked after them. So, when Priyamvada suggests her to water the plants whose flowering time was past, she readily agrees, feeling impressed by the idea. What might be Shakuntala's thoughts then? Write her **thoughts** in a paragraph.

Shakuntalam

ANSWERS

Comprehension – Textual passage

A.

1. The deer bends his neck in beauty as he looks back at the pursuing chariot.
2. A) Fear
3. The deer leaps so often and so high that it seems not to run, but to fly.
4. C) The terrain was rough.
5. strew

B.

1. Shakuntala feels that the mango tree is trying to tell her something because its branches move in the wind like fingers.
2. Priyamvada says that when she sees Shakuntala near the mango tree, it looks as if a vine were clinging to the tree
3. C) Light of the Grove
4. A) As a pretty pair showing youth and strength
5. Noun Phrase - The mango tree

   Prepositional Phrase - in his ripening fruit.

Discourses – Sample Answer

1. Review - Shakuntalam

The act, 'The Hunt' from the play Shakuntalam truly highlights the themes of blissful co-existence with nature, duty and love indeed. Written by Kalidasa in Sanskrit

and translated by Arthur William Ryder into English, the act uses simple language to convey the message of a harmonious living quite emphatically.

The act begins with King Dushyanta chasing a spotted deer in the forest along with the charioteer. But, he stops and drops the idea of killing the deer, when warned by the hermits. In fact, he realises then that the harmless deer belonged to the hermitage of Sage Kanva, where every being lived freely without fear. This in turn makes him realise his duty as a king to protect rather than to harm.

The sight of the pious hermitage seems to purify King Dushyanta. Before entering the hermitage, he hands over his jewels and bows to the charioteer and proceeds wearing modest garments. This shows that he has undergone a great transformation to embrace simplicity.

The harmonious existence of the people in the hermitage induces new revelations to the king as well. The approach of Shakuntala, Priyamvada and Anasuya towards the plants and trees reinforces his thoughts and duty as a King. In fact, it helps him resolve to abide by his duties.

The act certainly is simple but has a profound message to the reader. It has even a contemporary relevance since man needs to understand his duty towards nature. The act truly shows that man can live harmoniously with nature and it has the power to transform any individual, even a King.

Trills and Thrills : Bird Watching in India

Comprehension – Textual Passage

A. Read the following excerpt from *Trills and Thrills: Bird Watching in India* and answer the questions that follow.

I had grown up only on the traditional accounts of the nesting habits of birds. These were interesting enough for a keen bird photographer, as I was, to want to record on film. But while concealed in a canvas hide, perched high up on a stepladder, a few yards away from the nests, I noticed some unusual goings on which clearly showed that the birds had not read the textbooks.

While the field study of the birds is a peaceful occupation, it is not entirely without hazards. In elephant-ridden jungles in South India for instance, I have frequently found myself in disturbing situations. A wild elephant, suddenly come upon at close quarters – a situation by no means uncommon in parts of Karnataka and Kerala - can be an unnerving experience.... In fact, there is little danger from a wild elephant unless it happens to be a rouge or a female with a small calf.

1. What made Salim Ali take to photography early in his life?

2 Why does Salim Ali say that the 'birds had not read the textbooks'?

3 Which among the following is correct about ornithology?

A) It is not a peaceful occupation.

B) It is an interesting hobby.

C) It is hazardous.

D) It might put one in disturbing situations.

Choose the correct option.

i. A, B and C

ii. B, C and D

iii. A, C and D

iv. Only A

4. Read the following sentence and identify the **Noun Phrase** in the subject position and the **Verb Phrase.**

The field of study of birds is a peaceful occupation.

5. Choose the correct statement about birds from the following.

A) Birds read books and follow them.

B) Birds live as mentioned in the textbooks.

C) Birds' life differs from the descriptions in the textbooks.

D) Birds read textbooks but do not follow them.

B. Read the following excerpt from *Trills and Thrills: Bird Watching in India* and answer the questions that follow.

Ornithology may sometimes entail hazards of a different kind. I recall one particularly hair-raising incident along the Himalayan trail from Almora to the Lipu Lekh Pass on my way to Lake Manasarovar and Mount Kailas in 1945. It was at a particularly narrow part of the trail with a thousand feet of vertical scarp on one side and the roaring Kali river some 300 hundred feet vertically down the other. The porters pitched the tent there, though I had walked ahead of them. Just at that moment a tiny bird – how well I remember that Yellow-naped Yuhina! - got up to the top of a bush, some yards away on the flanking hill side.

Just as I got it in the field of my glasses, it hopped a bit further up. So, to get a better view I took a step back, with the glasses still glued to my eyes, entirely unmindful of where I was standing with my back to the abyss. As I did so, I felt a small pebble slip from under my heel and heard a faint continuing clatter as it went rolling down the hill. Still unmindful of anything untoward, I casually looked back over my shoulder. What I saw literally made my hair stand on end.

1. Why is the experience of the narrator termed as 'hair-raising' in the given passage?

   A) It was scary.
   B) It was pretty ordinary.
   C) It was surprising.
   D) It was entertaining.

Choose the right option.

   i. Only A
   ii. Only C
   iii. A and C
   iv. B and D

2. How is the terrain described by the narrator?

3. What did the narrator do to ensure he had a better view of the bird in focus?

4. Which among the following is an apt meaning for the word 'abyss' in this passage?

   A) A short deep ditch.

   B) A short narrow path.

   C) A big cliff

   D) A long deep ditch

5. Pick out the onomatopoeic word from the given words.

   A) Clutter

   B) Platter

   C) Clatter

   D) Batter

Discourse (7 Marks)

1. Salim Ali's *Trills and Thrills: Bird watching in India*, details his passion for ornithology along with different encounters with wildlife that were both thrilling and fearful. Based on your reading the lesson, prepare a **write up** explaining the thrills, unpredictability and the dangers inherent in his work.

2. "Bird watching as a hobby or profession is full of adventures, rewards and disappointments" says Dr. Salim Ali. In the light of your reading of the extract from his autobiography 'The Fall of a Sparrow', prepare a **speech** on the 'Trills and Thrills' of bird watching.

3. Salim Ali mentioned one of his fearful encounters with the wild elephants in the excerpt *Trills and Thrills : Birdwatching in India*. Nowadays in Kerala too, the human-wild animal conflicts are intensifying at an alarming rate. Prepare an **article** on the increasing rate of human-animal conflict, highlighting its reasons and recommendations to mitigate the rate of such conflicts.

Discourse (6 Marks)

4. Salim Ali and Baron Omar Rolf, an Austrian anthropologist, had a narrow escape from the attack of a wild tusker when they began exploring Parambikulam. Prepare a **news report** on the incident.

5. Dr. Salim Ali, known as the 'Birdman of India', was the first Indian to conduct systematic bird surveys across India. Using the details given below, prepare his **biographical sketch**.

Title	:	……
Full name	:	Dr. Salim Moizuddin Abdul Ali
Early life	:	Born in Mumbai on November 12, 1896 - Orphaned at a young age, raised by uncle, Amiruddin Tyabji
Occupation	:	Indian Ornithologist and Naturalist
Literary Work	:	Most famous work written along with S. Dillon Ripley is 'Handbook of Birds India and Pakistan' – His autobiography 'The fall of Sparrow'.
Legacy	:	Several species of bird, bird sanctuaries and institutions have been named after him.
Later life and Death	:	He passed away in 1987 (91). The Salim Ali Centre for Ornithology and Natural History (SACON) was established in his honour to continue his legacy of bird research and conservation.

6. You are very much inspired by the autobiography of Dr. Salim Ali, the famous Indian ornithologist and naturalist and wish to seek your higher studies at the

Salim Ali Centre for Ornithology and Natural History (SACON). Draft an **e-mail** to the director of SACON enquiring the details of courses offered there.

Discourse (4 Marks)

7. Ornithology entails hazards of a different kind as Salim Ali recollects while watching the yellow-napped Yuhina, which was nearly tragic for him. He couldn't resist expressing his feelings as a diary entry. Prepare the **diary**.

8. Imagine you are the secretary of the Nature club of your school. Your club decides to screen a documentary on Dr. Salim Ali, the Birdman of India. Draft a **notice** to be put up on the school notice board inviting the students and staff of the school for the screening.

9. Ornithology as a hobby or profession is full of adventures and hazards. Dr. Salim Ali had shared some of his adventurous experiences in his autobiographical extract *Trills and Thrills: Bird Watching in India*. Based on your reading of the excerpt, prepare a **paragraph** on the adventurous life of Salim Ali as an ornithologist.

10. Imagine that you get an opportunity to interview Dr. Salim Ali, the Bird Man of India. Prepare **five questions** you would like to ask him.

11. Read the passage given below and **frame four appropriate questions** based on it.

    My journey by the romantic Cochin Forest Tramway was in February 1946, shortly before it was dismantled to make way for the gigantic Parambikulam hydro-electric project. The huge dam and reservoir has now completely submerged Parambikulam and all the lovely country around it. We reached Parambikulam just as it was getting dark. In the verandah of the forest bungalow, I found a large group of Kadar adivasis, and in their midst, a bare-footed 'topless' European male in crumpled khaki shorts.

Trills and Thrills: Bird Watching in India

ANSWERS

Comprehension – Textual passage

A.

1. The wish to record on film made Salim Ali take to photography early in his life.

2. The unusual goings that he noticed in the nests were different from his textual information.

3. ii. B, C and D

4. Noun Phrase: The field of study of birds

   Verb Phrase: is a peaceful occupation

5. C) Birds' life differs from the descriptions in the textbooks.

B.

1. iii A and C

2. It was at a particularly narrow part of the trail with a thousand feet of vertical scarp on one side and the roaring Kali river some 300 hundred feet vertically down the other.

3. The narrator took a step back, with the glasses still glued to his eyes to have a better view of the bird in focus.

4. D) A long deep ditch

5. B) Clatter

Discourses – Sample Answer

3. Article

Human-Wild Animal Conflict: A Threat to Peaceful Life

Special Correspondent

Human – wild animal conflict refers to negative interactions between humans and wildlife. It occurs with various negative results such as loss of both human and wildlife, loss of crops, damage and destruction of habitat etc. The conflict is driven by factors like population growth, habitat loss, and changes in cropping pattern and human encroachment in the wildlife. Conflicts primarily involve animals like elephants and tigers, with significant impacts on the safety and livelihoods of communities living near forests.

As human population expands into wild animal habitats, natural wildlife territory is displaced. It leads to the reduction in the availability of natural food sources of wild animals. Hence, they are forced to seek alternate sources. Moreover, in Kerala the population density of wildlife and humans increase with overlaps in geographical areas. The encroachment of human beings into the natural migration routes of the wild animals can also be considered as one of the reasons for the human-wild animal conflicts.

The most prevalent mitigation measure for this conflict is by erecting barriers like bio fencing, solar fencing, and elephant trench to prevent the entry of animals into the cultivated and residential area. But such measures taken by the government are partially effective. Awareness about the habitats of wildlife and tolerance to wildlife needs to be propagated among the local communities in order to mitigate such conflicts. Long term mitigation measures like relocating and rehabilitating ferocious animals to near natural habitats, monitoring of problematic animals and reducing commercial activities in forest areas can also be adopted to mitigate human-wild animal conflict in future.

10. Interview Questions

1. What motivated you to choose ornithology as your profession?
2. What is the most significant thing you have learned about birds?
3. In your opinion, what are the biggest threats to India's bird population today?
4. How do you see the scope of ornithology in this modern world?
5. What were the challenges you faced while pursuing ornithology as a profession?

11. Framing Questions

1. When did the narrator journey by the Cochin Forest Tramway?
2. Why was the tramway dismantled?
3. Which is the hydro-electric project mentioned here?
4. What did the narrator find in the verandah of the forest bungalow?

The Wild Swans at Coole

Comprehension – Textual Poem

A. Read the lines from the poem *The Wild Swans at Coole* and answer the questions that follow.

The trees are in their autumn beauty,

The woodland paths are dry,

Under the October twilight the water

Mirrors a still sky;

Upon the brimming water among the stones

Are nine-and-fifty swans.

The nineteenth autumn has come upon me

Since I first made my count;

I saw, before I had well finished,

All suddenly mount

And scatter wheeling in great broken rings

Upon their clamorous wings.

1. How does the poet bring in the beauty of the season in the given lines?

2. What does the poet mean by 'the October twilight'?

   A) The fading light of the year.

   B) A moment of transition.

   C) The poet's late stage of life.

   D) All of the above.

3. How do you interpret the line, **'**The nineteenth autumn has come upon me

Since I first made my count'**?**

A) The poet is nineteen years old.

B) The poet is watching the swans after nineteen years.

C) The poet is visiting the place for the nineteenth time.

D) The poet visited the place eighteen years ago.

4. Identify the rhyme scheme followed in the first stanza.

B. Read the lines from the poem *The Wild Swans at Coole* and answer the questions that follow.

I have looked upon those brilliant creatures,

And now my heart is sore.

All's changed since I, hearing at twilight,

The first time on this shore,

The bell-beat of their wings above my head,

Trod with a lighter tread.

Unwearied still, lover by lover,

They paddle in the cold

Companionable streams or climb the air;

Their hearts have not grown old;

Passion or conquest, wander where they will,

Attend upon them still.

1. Why is the poet's heart 'sore'?

2. In the line *"I have looked upon those brilliant creatures,"* what do the "brilliant creatures" refer to?

   A) Angels

   B) Dolphins

   C) Stars

   D) Swans

3. In the phrase *"Unwearied still, lover by lover,"* what quality of the swans is being emphasized?

   A) Their exhaustion after migration.

   B) Their enduring vitality and companionship.

   C) Their separation from one another.

   D) Their fear of humans.

4. Identify the poetic device used in the line "The bell-beat of their wings above my head".

C. Read the following lines from *The Wild Swans at Coole* and prepare an appreciation, focusing on the theme, poetic devices, tone and style.

The trees are in their autumn beauty,
The woodland paths are dry,
Under the October twilight the water
Mirrors a still sky;
Upon the brimming water among the stones
Are nine-and-fifty swans.

The nineteenth autumn has come upon me

Since I first made my count;

I saw, before I had well finished,

All suddenly mount

And scatter wheeling in great broken rings

Upon their clamorous wings.

D. Read the following lines from *The Wild Swans at Coole* and 'That Time of Year Thou Mayst in Me Behold' (SONNET 73) by William Shakespeare.

The Wild Swans at Coole	***That Time of Year Thou Mayst in Me Behold*** ***(SONNET 73)***
I have looked upon those brilliant creatures, And now my heart is sore. All's changed since I, hearing at twilight, The first time on this shore, The bell beat of their wings above my head, Trod with a lighter tread.	In me thou see'st the twilight of such day As after sunlight fadeth in the west, Which by and by the black night doth take away, Death's second self, that seals up all in rest *Thou – you* *Fadeth – fade* *Doth - do*

Growing old is an inevitable reality of life and its realisation brings grief and disappointment. W B Yeats' poem *'The Wild Swans at Coole'* and Shakespeare's sonnet 73 portrays this grief. Analysing the given lines from both the poems, prepare a **paragraph** on the inevitable reality of ageing and grief.

The Wild Swans at Coole

ANSWERS

Comprehension – Textual Poem

A.

1. The trees are in their autumn beauty and the woodland paths are dry.

2. D. All of the above.

3. B. The poet is watching the swans after nineteen years.

4. abcbd

B.

1. The youthful vigour of the swans makes the poet's heart sore.

2. D. Swans

3. B. Their enduring vitality and companionship

4. Alliteration

Language Elements

Reported Speech

A. Report the following dialogue.

1. King : Is the hermit father there?
   Hermit : No, he has left his daughter to welcome guests, and has just gone to Somatirtha.
2. Anasuya : Father Kanva cares more for the hermitage trees than you.
   Shakuntala : It isn't Father's bidding. I feel like a real sister to them.

B. Report the following dialogue.

1. Salim Ali : How beautiful the bird is!

   Journalist : How long have you been watching these beautiful birds?

2. Student : Do you find bird watching quite enchanting?

   Salim Ali : Yes. I find it very interesting.

Editing

1. Edit the passage. Errors are given in bold.

One of the standard **question** (a) to me is about the thrilling adventures **on** (b) a lifetime of exploring for birds. My answer must **seemed** (c) disappointing. **ornithology** (d) as a hobby or **profesion**, (e) though full of adventures, rewards and disappointments, is usually one of **a** (f) most peaceful of pursuits.

2. Edit the passage. Errors are given in bold.

He **spuns** (a) round with the **agibility** (b) of a cat and sprinted as fast as his long legs could **cary** (c) him, looking neither to right **or** (d) left. He soon outdistanced me by **an** (e) hundred yards, and it looked as if he would never **stoped** (f) running.

Cloze Type

Complete the following passage choosing the right words from the bracket.

1. O King, we are ---(a)--- our way ---(b)--- gather firewood. Here, on the bank ---(c)--- Malini, you may see ---(d)--- hermitage of Father Kanva, ---(e)--- which Shakuntala presides as our guardian... *pray, enter here ---(f)--- receive a welcome.

(over, to, the, of, on, and)

2. I think I hear someone to the right ---(a)--- the grove. Ah, here are hermit girls, ---(b)--- watering pots. They are coming ---(c)--- this direction ---(d)--- water the young trees. I will draw back ---(e)--- the shade and wait ---(f)--- them.

(to, with, in, of, for, into)

3. ---- (a)---- the field study ----(b)---- birds is ----(c)---- peaceful occupation, it is not entirely ---(d)---- hazards. In elephant-ridden jungles in South India ----(e)---- instance, I have frequently found myself ----(f)---- disturbing situations.

(without, in, while, of, for, a)

4. Ornithology may sometimes entail hazards ---(a)--- a different kind. I recall one particularly hair-raising incident ---(b)--- the Himalayan trail ---(c)--- Almora to the Lipu Lekh Pass ---(d)--- my way to Lake Manasarovar ---(e)--- Mount Kailas ---(f)--- 1945.

(and, of, on, from, in, along)

Phrasal Verbs

Complete the following paragraphs using appropriate forms of the phrasal verbs given in the brackets.

1. King Dushyanta .....(a)..... on his hunting. Before long, he .....(b)..... a deer. Though he followed it strenuously, threatened of the arrow the deer started moving very fast. He .....(c)..... to shoot the spotted deer. Meanwhile, he heard a voice which warned him not to kill the deer as it belonged to the hermitage. The humble king .....(d)..... his idea and placed the arrow back into the quiver. Finally, he decided to……(e)…….. the hunt.

(make up one's mind, give up, set out, call off, come across)

2. Bird watching is not just a hobby. It is far more than that. When we .....(a)..... bird watching, we will definitely enjoy it. As we …….(b)…… observing birds very closely, we may.....(c)..... the very rare ones too. In fact, there are a number of people around us who.....(d).....bird watching as a passion or profession. But, we have to keep in mind that it isn't easy. There are dangers too as Salim Ali himself quoted in his autobiography about the experience with a tusker. So,

we have to be prepared to .....(e)..... any challenge, whatsoever and thereby enjoy watching the beautiful birds.

(ward off, come upon, go on, take up, get into)

Completion of Dialogue

1. Complete the following dialogue.

Shakuntala : Oh, girls, that mango tree is trying to tell me something, ____(a)_____ ?

Priyamvada : _____(b)_____ ?

Shakuntala : It moves its branches in the wind like fingers.

Priyamvada : You had better _____(c)_____.

Shakuntala : Why should I stand right here?

Priyamvada : If you stand there, _____(d)_____

Shakuntala : Oh ! that is why they call you a flatterer.

Priyamvada : Look at this Jasmine vine which you named as Light of the Grove

Shakuntala : The more you care for it, _____(e)_____

Priyamvada : That is true dear.

2. Complete the following dialogue.

Forest Guard : Sir, Are you fine? _____(a)_____?

Dr. Salim Ali : Yes, of course. I had a great escape just now near the cliff.

Forest Guard : _____(b)_____?

Dr. Salim Ali : I was watching that yellow-naped Yuhina.

Forest Guard : What happened then?

Dr. Salim Ali : If I had stepped back, _____(c)_____.

Forest Guard : Thank God, you are safe

Dr. Salim Ali : Would you mind _____(d)_____?

Forest Guard : Sir, please take this bottle of water.

Dr. Salim Ali : _____(e)_____.

Vocabulary

Fill in the blanks with the appropriate word in the brackets.

1. A healthy lifestyle is very important these days since everybody is experiencing a lot of stress. Although we have a system to monitor our health, we need to be aware of the help we could have during an emergency. A ……(a)……. helps us to assess the condition of our heart. Whereas a ……..(b)…… helps us to know how our lungs are functioning. So, the role of each specialist becomes important when the need arises.

   (pulmonologist, dermatologist, cardiologist)

2. **Fill in the blanks with the appropriate form of the words in the brackets.**

   ……(a)…… is preferred by many enthusiasts and we could see a genuine craze among them. They enjoy ……..(b)…….. new places making new memories all the while. It has become a very popular pastime to overcome the stress of life.

   (explore, travel)

Unit 4

ANSWERS

Language Elements

Reported Speech

A.

1. The King asked the hermit whether the hermit father was there.
   The hermit replied negatively and said that he had left his daughter to welcome guests, and had just gone to Somatirtha.
2. Anasuya told Shakuntala that Father Kanva cared more for the hermitage trees than her.
   Shakuntala replied that it wasn't Father's bidding and added that she felt like a real sister to them.

B.

1. Salim Ali exclaimed that the bird was beautiful.
   The journalist asked Salim Ali how long he had been watching those beautiful birds.
2. The Student asked Salim Ali whether he found bird watching quite enchanting.
   Salim Ali asserted and said that he found it very interesting.

Editing

1.

(a) questions	(b) in	(c) seem
(d) Ornithology	(e) profession	(f) the

2.

(a) spun	(b) agility	(c) carry
(d) nor	(e) a	(f) stop

Cloze Type

1.	(a)	on	(b)	to
	(c)	of	(d)	the
	(e)	over	(f)	and
2	(a)	of	(b)	with
	(c)	in	(d)	to
	(e)	into	(f)	for
3.	(a)	While	(b)	of
	(c)	a	(d)	without
	(e)	for	(f)	in
4.	(a)	of	(b)	along
	(c)	from	(d)	on
	(e)	and	(f)	in

Phrasal Verbs

1. (a) set out
   (b) came across
   (c) made up his mind
   (d) gave up
   (e) call off
2. (a) get into
   (b) go on
   (c) come upon
   (d) take up
   (e) ward off

Completion of Dialogue

1.

(a) Isn't it?

(b) How do you know that?

(c) stand right there.

(d) you will look lovelier. (any suitable answer)

(e) The more it flowers.

2.

(a) Did something happen to you?

(b) What were you doing?

(c) I would have fallen into the cliff.

(d) Giving me some water.

(e) Thank you very much.

Vocabulary

1. (a) cardiologist (b) pulmonologist
2. (a) Travelling (b) exploring

Unit - 5

Songs of the Self

Beloved Boles

Comprehension – Textual passage

A. Read the following excerpt from *Beloved Boles* and answer the questions that follow.

When I was a student at Moscow, I happened to live alongside a Polish woman, Teresa by name. She was tall and strong, with bushy black eyebrows, dark brown hair and a large coarse face. The gleam of her dark eyes, her thick bass voice, and her muscular vigour, horrified me. I lived on the top floor and her room was opposite mine.

I never left my door open when I knew her to be at home. Sometimes I chanced to meet her on the staircase or in the yard, and she would smile at me. Occasionally, I saw her drunk, with bleary eyes, and tousled hair. On such occasions she would speak to me.

"How d'ye do, Mr Student!" she'd say with a stupid laugh. I should have liked to change my quarters; but my little chamber was a nice one. There was such a wide view from the window, and it was always so quiet in the street below–so I endured.

1. Who was the student's neighbour at Moscow?

2. What features of Teresa horrified the student?

   A) Muscular vigour
   B) Gleam of eyes
   C) Bushy black eye brows
   D) Thick bass voice

Choose the right option.

(i) Only D

(ii) All the features.

(iii) A and B

(iv) A, B and D

3. Why did the student keep his door closed when Teresa was at home?

4. Even though the student liked to change his quarters, he endured. Pick out the reason for that.

A) Teresa was his friend.

B) He loved Teresa.

C) He loved his chamber.

D) He loved her smile.

5. "Teresa was a tall woman with bushy black eyebrows and a large coarse face".
Pick out the coordinating conjunction used in this sentence.

B. Read the following excerpt from *Beloved Boles* and answer the questions that follow.

I understood at last. And I felt so sick, so miserable, so ashamed, somehow. Alongside of me, not three yards away, lived a human creature who had nobody in the world to treat her kindly. With no one to be affectionate to her, this human being had invented a friend for herself!

"Look, now! you wrote me a letter to Boles, and I gave it to someone else to read it to me; and when they read it to me, I listened and fancied that Boles was there. And I asked you to write me a letter from Boles to Teresa–that is to me. When they write such a letter for me, and read it to me, I feel quite sure that Boles is there. And life grows easier for me."

"Take you for a blockhead!" said I to myself when I heard this.

And thenceforth, regularly, twice a week, I wrote a letter to Boles, and an answer from Boles to Teresa. She, of course, listened to them, and wept like anything. She roared, I should say, with her bass voice. And in return for my service, she began to mend the holes I had in my socks, shirts, and other articles of clothing. Three months later she was thrown into prison for some reason or the other and by now she must surely be dead.

1. Why did the narrator feel sick, miserable and ashamed?
2. What was the technique adapted by Teresa to make life easier for her?
3. How often did the narrator write letters to Boles and Teresa?

A) Daily

B) Weekly

C) Twice a week

D) Occasionally

4. What happened to Teresa after three months?

A) She died.

B) She was mad.

C) She turned imprisoned.

D) She fled from there.

Choose the correct option.

(i) Only A

(ii) Only C

(iii) B and C

(iv) None of the above

5. Find out a word from the passage which means ‘a stupid person’.

Discourse (7 Marks)

1. The idiom 'You cannot judge a book by its cover' unfolds in the story *Beloved Boles* by Maxim Gorky. Teresa, the central character of this story proves that the seemingly quiet world of the human mind could prove to be a world of turmoil. On the basis of your reading of the story prepare a **review** focusing on its theme characterisation and plot development.

   [Hints: student living alongside Polish woman — appearance horrifies — keeps away —Teresa approaches to write letter — denies writing reply — regrets his deed — realises her loneliness - starts writing her letters]

2. Being alone is really a horrible thing in one's life. Teresa in the story *Beloved Boles* creates an imaginary companion to get rid of her loneliness. Based on the reading of the story, prepare a **write up** on the role of a true companion to fulfil one's emotional needs.

   [Hints:- Teresa longs for a friend – she creates Boles – requests Mr. Student to draft letters to both Boles and Teresa – she asks someone to read the letters – feels happy that Boles is there with her.]

3. The invention of the beloved Boles is Teresa's desperate attempt to assert her humanity and secure a feeling of love and affection in an indifferent and judgemental world. Write an **article** for your school magazine on the topic 'Impact of loneliness and social isolation on mental health'.

Discourse (6 Marks)

4. The terribly lonely Teresa has a thick bass voice and rough face. She is the central character of Maxim Gorky's story *Beloved Boles*. The wrong perception of the narrator about the lady paves way to sympathy and compassion as the story progresses. Prepare a **character sketch** of Teresa highlighting her physical and personality traits.

5. Mr. Student felt sorry for Teresa when she was imprisoned. She became alone once again in her life. In order to console her, Mr. Student writes a letter to her. Prepare the likely **letter**.

6. Imagine that Teresa met a co-prisoner who helped her to continue her habit of writing letters. She shares her experiences with Mr. Student to her co-prisoner. Write the likely **narrative**.

7. Prepare the **profile** of Maxim Gorky using the hints given.

Birth	:	March 28,1868, Nizhny Novgorod, Russia
Full name	:	Alexei Maximovich Peshkov
Nationality	:	Russian
Career	:	Short story writer, Novelist, Intellectual revolutionary, critic
Major works	:	Foma Gordeyev (1899) a novel, The Lower Depths (1902) a play, The Mother (1906) a propaganda novel
Official Honours	:	"Father of Soviet Literature", First President of the Soviet Writer's union
Death	:	June 18,1936, in Gorki (near Moscow)

Discourse (4 Marks)

8. Mr. Student became very sad at the plight of Teresa when he came to know that Boles was a person she had invented. He could also understand her longing for a human connection. He wrote his feelings in a diary. Prepare the likely **diary entry.**

9. Mr Student was astounded to know that there was nobody called Boles. He shares the strange wishes of Teresa with one of his friends. Write the likely **conversation** between them.

10. A shoulder to rest on is a wish that any human longs for. How far is it justified through the actions of Teresa? Write a short **paragraph** on the need of human connections and socialisation based on the reading of *Beloved Boles*.

11. Read the passage given below and **frame four appropriate questions** based on it.

When I was a student at Moscow, I happened to live alongside a Polish woman, Teresa by name. She was tall and strong, with bushy black eyebrows, dark brown hair and a large coarse face. The gleam of her dark eyes, her thick bass voice, and her muscular vigour, horrified me. I lived on the top floor and her room was opposite mine.

Unit 5

Beloved Boles

ANSWERS

Comprehension – Textual passage

A.

1. Teresa, a Polish woman, was the student's neighbour at Moscow.
2. iv) A, B and D
3. Teresa's appearance horrified the student and he did not want to meet her. So, he kept his door closed when Teresa was at home.
4. C) He loved his chamber.
5. and

B.

1. Teresa, who lived near him, was a human creature who had nobody in this world to treat her kindly. This realisation made him feel sick, miserable and ashamed.
2. Teresa created an imaginary friend and lover, Mr. Boles and tried to maintain correspondence with him to make life easier for her.
3. C) Twice a week.
4. (ii) Only C
5. Blockhead

11. Framing Questions

1. Where did the narrator live when he was in Moscow?
2. What was the nationality of the woman mentioned in the passage?
3. Was the narrator horrified by the looks of the woman?
4. How is Teresa's physical appearance described in the passage?

Preference Nationale

Comprehension – Textual passage

A. Read the following excerpt from *Preference Nationale* and answer the questions that follow.

The law changed very quietly, thanks to Mr Borders: if you're married to a French citizen, it will now take two years for you to claim the benefits of citizenship. By this delay, Mr Borders is relying on the nature of his countrymen to break up the relationship. Then, as the ex-wife of a Frenchman, the foreign woman becomes no more than an ex-object. And as with any object, she has no rights, not even the right to earn an honest living. They won't give me citizenship, but my Senegalese cat has his papers. Perhaps it's because he's ginger.

Laws only gather pace when ordinary people start applying them. Termites can cause the collapse of African mahogany trees, and the size of an anthill depends on the number of worker ants. It is thus the small employers who make the policy of *preference nationale* effective.

1. What change did 'Mr Borders' bring to the process of granting French citizenship?
2. Which of the following statements is **TRUE** about the ex-wife of a Frenchman?

   A. She could get citizenship easily.

   B. She has all rights.

   C. She has the right to earn an honest living.

   D. She doesn't have any rights.
3. Who makes the policy of *preference nationale* effective?

   A. Government

   B. Policy makers

   C. Small employers

   D. Society

4. When do laws gather pace according to the narrator?
5. Identify the **Noun Phrase** in the subject position and the **Verb Phrase** in the sentence given below.

   The size of an anthill depends on the number of worker ants.

B. Read the following excerpt from *Préférence Nationale* and answer the questions that follow.

The next morning I went to the bakery. Apart from the chocolate cakes, everything was white. The boss welcomed me with a German moustache, an Alsace accent and a hat in the colours of the French flag. From the way he stared at me, I knew I hadn't made it through the qualifying round. This man didn't like chocolate in the flesh. I forced myself to smile, and said, "Hello, sir. I've come for the job you advertised."

1. How is the owner of the bakery described in the passage?
2. How did the narrator know that she hadn't made it through the qualifying round?
3. Why did the narrator go to the bakery?

   A) To meet the bakery owner for a job.

   B) To buy chocolate cakes.

   C) To advertise a job vacancy.

   D) To order delicious delicacies.

4. 'This man didn't like chocolate in the flesh.' What does this imply?

   A) No racial discrimination.

   B) Racial discrimination.

   C) Little racial discrimination.

   D) None of the above.

5. Identify the **Noun Phrase** in the subject position and the **Verb Phrase** in the sentence given below.

The boss welcomed me with a German moustache.

Discourse (7 Marks)

1. The narrator in the story *Preference Nationale* struggles a lot to establish her identity in a foreign country. Being a black woman, she faces setbacks while searching for a job. Based on your reading of the story, prepare a **review.**

   [Hints: identity as an ex-wife of a Frenchman – searching for a job in a bakery – rejected due to the lack of Alsace accent – applied for the post of Tutor – again rejected - looking for a European personality –suggests this job for her college mate - friend offers her the job of a cleaner]

2. The Ex-wife of a Frenchman becomes an ex-object. She doesn't have any rights; not even the right to earn an honest living. Fatou Diome was a victim of this strange law of the French. Prepare a **write up** focusing on the impact of this law on the narrator.

3. The story *Preference Nationale* highlights the turmoils of racism, prejudice and a system that favour people based on their origin rather than merit. Prepare a **speech** on 'The Need to End Racism', to be delivered in the school assembly on March 21st in connection with the International Day for the Elimination of Racial Discrimination

Discourse (6 Maks)

4. The narrator in the story *Preference Nationale* confronts an identity crisis throughout the story. She always tries to establish her identity though it often

fails. But her determination and positive outlook helps her to move ahead. Prepare the **character sketch** of the narrator.

5. Young, educated, migrant women experience discrimination, humiliation and denied jobs, because of their race or being relegated to domestic work. This matter is being reported in a local newspaper. Prepare the likely **news report**.

6. Even though she was well qualified and well mannered, Fatou Diome failed to find a job due to the discrimination of nationality and race. Her struggles and humiliation is vividly portrayed in the story *Preference Nationale*. Prepare a detailed **narrative** of the story.

7. Imagine, you are a citizen living in the same city as the narrator. You have come to know the incidents of prejudice and 'Preference Nationale' happening in places like the bakery and the super market. Write a **letter** to the Editor of a popular news paper requesting him to publish an editorial in this regard to create awareness among the public.

8. Prepare a **profile** of Fatou Diome using the details given below.

Birth	:	1968, Senegalese Island of Liodior
Nationality	:	French, Senegalese
Education	:	Degree in Literature at the University of Strasburg
Occupation	:	Novelist, Short story writer, Essayist.
Major works	:	La Preference Nationale (2001), La Ventre De I - Atlantique (2003) Marianne porte plaintel (2017)
Key themes and Styles	:	Migration and Exile, Racism and Injustice Semi Autobiographical and didactic style
Recognition	:	Cultural Diversity Award (2024)

Discourse (4 Marks)

9. Fatou Diome meets the Madame at the cafe with the hope of getting the job of a tutor handling French lessons. But what she experienced was mere humiliation. Wounded by the experience she jots down her feelings in her diary. Prepare the likely **diary entry**.

10. The narrator in the story *Preference Nationale* was deeply insulted by the Madame at the city centre cafe. Immediately after this incident the narrator met her French friend. Prepare a possible **conversation** between the narrator and her French friend.

11. Read the passage given below and frame **four appropriate questions** based on it.

That evening, I called a friend from college, a real white girl. She was looking for some part-time work while she did her degree. I gave her the cashier's number. The next evening her happy voice rang out of my answering machine, "Thanks for the tip. I started work for that lady this morning. But if you're interested, she has a neighbour who's looking for a cleaner."

Preference Nationale

ANSWERS

Comprehension – Textual passage

A.

1. The change that Mr. Borders brought to the process of granting French citizenship is that a foreigner married to a French citizen must wait two years to claim the benefits of citizenship.
2. D. She doesn't have any rights.
3. C. Small employers
4. According to the narrator laws gather pace when ordinary people start applying them.
5. Noun Phrase : The size of an anthill
   Verb Phrase : depends on the number of worker ants

B.

1. The owner of the bakery is described as a man with a German moustache, an Alsace accent, and a hat in the colours of the French flag.
2. The narrator knew that she hadn't made it through the qualifying round, from the way the bakery owner stared at her.
3. A. To meet the bakery owner for a job.
4. B. There was racial discrimination.
5. Noun Phrase : The boss
   Verb Phrase : welcomed me with a German moustache

11. Framing Questions

1. Whom did the narrator call that evening?
2. What was her friend looking for?
3. Was her friend happy?
4. What was the offer given by her friend to the narrator by her friend?

Mirror

Comprehension – Textual Poem

A. Read the lines from the poem *Mirror* and answer the questions that follow.

I am silver and exact. I have no preconceptions.
Whatever I see I swallow immediately
Just as it is, unmisted by love or dislike.
I am not cruel, only truthful,
The eye of a little god, four-cornered.
Most of the time I meditate on the opposite wall.
It is pink, with speckles. I have looked at it so long
I think it is part of my heart. But it flickers.
Faces and darkness separate us over and over.

1. Who is the speaker in the poem?
2. The phrase "I have no preconceptions" suggests that the mirror is -------
   A. Biased
   B. Objective and impartial
   C. Loving and kind
   D. Confused about reality
3. What is reflected in the mirror most of the time?
   A. The face of the poet
   B. A curtain
   C. A pink wall with speckles
   D. A window
4. What separates the mirror from the pink wall with speckles?

B. Read the lines from the poem *Mirror* and answer the questions that follow.

Now I am a lake. A woman bends over me,

Searching my reaches for what she really is.

Then she turns to those liars, the candles or the moon.

I see her back, and reflect it faithfully.

She rewards me with tears and an agitation of hands.

I am important to her. She comes and goes.

Each morning it is her face that replaces the darkness.

In me she has drowned a young girl, and in me an old woman

Rises toward her day after day, like a terrible fish.

1. What does the woman search for in the lake?
2. Who are the 'liars' mentioned in the poem?

   A. Mirror and Wall

   B. Lake and Water

   C. Reflection and Darkness

   D. Candles and the Moon
3. What emotion does the woman show after seeing her reflection?

   A. Anger and hatred

   B. Sadness and frustration

   C. Joy and relief

D. Indifference and calmness

4. Identify the poetic device used in the line "Rises toward her day after day, like a terrible fish"

C. Read the following lines from the poem *Mirror* and prepare an appreciation focusing on the use of theme and literary devices.

I am silver and exact. I have no preconceptions.

Whatever I see I swallow immediately

Just as it is, unmisted by love or dislike.

I am not cruel, only truthful,

The eye of a little god, four-cornered.

Most of the time I meditate on the opposite wall.

It is pink, with speckles. I have looked at it so long

I think it is part of my heart. But it flickers.

Faces and darkness separate us over and over.

D. Read the following lines from the poem '*Mirror'* by Sylvia Plath and '*An Introduction'* by Kamala Das.

Mirror	***An Introduction***
Now I am a lake. A woman bends over me, Searching my reaches for what she really is. Then she turns to those liars, the candles or the moon.	I am an Indian, very brown, born in Malabar, I speak three languages, write in Two, dream in one.

I see her back, and reflect it faithfully. She rewards me with tears and an agitation of hands. I am important to her. She comes and goes. Each morning it is her face that replaces the darkness. In me she has drowned a young girl, and in me an old woman Rises toward her day after day, like a terrible fish.	Don't write in English, they said, English is Not your mother-tongue. Why not leave Me alone, critics, friends, visiting cousins, Every one of you? Why not let me speak in Any language I like? The language I speak, Becomes mine, its distortions, its queernesses All mine, mine alone.

Compare the themes of the two poems *An Introduction* and *Mirror* and write a paragraph focusing on how these poems explore the notions of identity, self-awareness and personal struggle.

Mirror

ANSWERS

Comprehension – Textual Poem

A.

1. A mirror is the speaker in the poem.

2. B. Objective and impartial

3. C. A pink wall with speckles

4. Faces of people and darkness separate the mirror from the wall.

B.

1. The woman searches for her true identity and self in the lake.

2. D. Candles and the Moon

3. B. Sadness and frustration

4. Simile

C. Appreciation (Sample)

The poem 'Mirror' by Sylvia Plath focuses on the theme of unbiased reflection of reality and the emotional struggle of a person, confronting ageing and self-identity. The speaker of the poem takes the perspectives of a mirror as well as a lake.

In the first stanza the mirror serves as a symbol of absolute honesty. It declares, *"I am silver and exact. I have no preconceptions."* This shows the objectivity of the mirror as it reflects faithfully whatever appears before it, without bias or distortion. The mirror is not cruel, but simply honest. It's like a small god's eye, with four corners. Most of the time, the mirror focuses on the pink, speckled wall that stands opposite to it. The mirror has been staring at this wall for so long that it thinks the wall is in fact an essential part of itself.

In the second stanza, the mirror transforms into a lake. The woman who bends over it is seeking her true self, but she sees the ageing face that time has imposed upon her. In order to console herself she turns to the candles or the moon. From that temporary relief she returns to the mirror and it reflects her accurately. She rewards the mirror with tears and an agitation of hands. The mirror is so important to her. Every day starts with the woman's face taking the place of the darkness that the mirror reflected all night. Time has passed so quickly that the young girl she used to be has disappeared, and the image of her youthful face has been replaced by the reflection of an ageing woman. The expression "terrible fish" represents the woman's fear of ageing and the inevitable decay of beauty.

Though the poem is written in free verse and doesn't have a regular rhyme scheme, the use of assonance, simile and the brilliant use of personification of mirror and lake made the poem an enchanting one.

Language Elements

Reported Speech

A. Report the following dialogue.

1 Teresa : Can't you write a letter for me?

Student : Yes, of course. It's my pleasure.

2 Teresa : Why don't people give us a place in society?

Student : The reasons are up to the people.

B. Report the following dialogue.

1 Boss : You will have to speak in Alsatian.

Diome : Why should I?

2 Madame : I want a European-type person.

Diome : If it is so, then I won't fit in anyways.

Editing

Edit the passage. Errors are given in bold.

1 I remained with a very **unpleasent** (a) feeling in my mind. I listened. Her door was flung **opened** (b) violently and then slammed shut. I thought it over, and resolved **of** (c) go to her. I'd invite her to come back in here and **right** (d) everything she wanted. I entered her apartment. She **is** (e) sitting at the table, leaning on her elbows, with her head in her **hand** (f).

Edit the passage. Errors are given in bold.

2 I wrote down the **addres** (a) and told a **french** (b) friend about it **of** (c) the phone that evening. "Are you nuts?" she protested. "You could **done** (d) better than that. I've the same qualifications as you and I'm **finish** (e) my teacher training. **you** (f) will be bored selling bread and pastries all day!"

Cloze Type

1. I never left my door open when I knew her to be ---(a)--- home. Sometimes I chanced ---(b)--- meet her ---(c)--- the staircase or ---(d)--- the yard, and she would smile at me. Occasionally, I saw her drunk, ---(e)--- bleary eyes, ---(f)--- tousled hair.

(with, on, at, in, and, to)

2. She leaped ---(a)--- her seat, came towards me ---(b)--- flashing eyes. Laying her hands ---(c)--- my shoulders, she began ---(d)--- whisper: "Look you, now! It's like this. There's no Boles ---(e)--- all, and there's no Teresa ---(f)---.

(on, at, from, either, to, with)

3. Laws only gather pace ---(a)--- ordinary people start applying them. Termites can cause the collapse ---(b)--- African mahogany trees, and the size of ---(c)--- anthill depends ---(d)--- the number of worker ants. It is thus ---(e)--- small employers ---(f)--- make the policy of *preference nationale* effective.

(on, an, who, the, of, when)

4. The next morning I went ---(a)--- the bakery. Apart ---(b)--- the chocolate cakes, everything was white. The boss welcomed me ---(c)--- a German moustache, ---(d)--- Alsace accent and a hat ---(e)--- the colours ---(f)--- the French flag.

(with, from, of, in, to, an)

Phrasal Verbs

1. The student decided to .....(a)..... the letters regularly twice a week to Boles and an answer from Boles to Teresa when he understood the reality. He had .....(b)..... the request earlier. But, now he couldn't .....(c)..... the humble plea from her, which was genuine too. In return, Teresa would ….....(d)..... doing his little works to help him. This ….....(e)..... for some time, when she was thrown into prison for some reason or the other.

(go on, go about, put aside, put down, turn down)

2. Diome .....(a)..... the café to meet the Madame, who had contacted her to get a tutor for her daughter. She had informed her that she would have .....(b)..... a white jersey with white stripes so that Diome could spot her immediately. When they came face to face Madame .....(c)..... her wish to have a European tutor rather than her. Diome felt offended and decided to .....(d)..... the offer because she felt discriminated. She felt right away that she couldn't .....(e)..... with such people anyways and moved away.

(put across, put on, turn down, get along, call at)

Completion of Dialogue

1. Complete the following dialogue.

Student : _____(a)_____?

Teresa : I want to beg a favour of you. Will you grant it?

Student : Let me know what it is?

Teresa : I want to send a letter to someone. _____(b)_____?

Student : Yes, I can write it. Sit here and dictate, _____(c)_____?

Teresa : Ok Sir, I shall dictate it.

Student : If you dictate it clearly, _____(d)_____.

Teresa : I want to address the letter to Mr. Boles. Won't you do it for me?

Student : _____ (e) _____

2. Complete the following Dialogue

Narrator : Good morning, Sir. I badly need a job. Can you help me?

Owner : Oh! You speak Alsatian, _____(a)_____?

Narrator : No, sir I don't speak Alsatian.

Owner : If you don't speak Alsatian, _____(b)_____.

Narrator : But sir, I can work hard and I shall serve people politely.

Owner : You had better, _____(c)_____.

Narrator : I won't go back to my country now. I should find a job.

Owner : _____(d)_____?

Narrator : I came here because of your advertisement.

Owner : But I can't keep you here for the job. You may leave now.

Narrator : _____(e) _____.

Vocabulary

1. Use the words given in the brackets to make portmanteau words and fill in the blanks suitably.

A ……(a)…… is blessed with a plethora of information available at their fingertips. There are various websites that people can access to avail a variety of programmes. Even …….(b)…….. seem very popular, with a huge number of content creators promoting their ideas through videos and audio clips. Indeed, the world has been taken by the storm of the Internet.

(citizen, ipod, internet, broadcast)

2. Fill in the blanks with suitable coordinating conjunctions given in the brackets.

(a) Diome didn't want to oblige Madame, …….. she felt humiliated by the lady.

(b) Teresa knew that there was nobody like Boles, …… she insisted Mr Student o write letters.

(and, yet, for)

Unit 5

Language Elements

ANSWERS

Reported Speech

A.

1. Teresa asked the Student whether he couldn't write a letter for her.

   The Student asserted and said that it was his pleasure.

2. Teresa asked the Student why people didn't give them a place in society.

   The Student replied that the reasons were up to the people.

B.

1. The boss told Diome that she would have to speak in Alsatian.

   Diome asked the boss why she should.

2. Madame told Diome that she wanted a European-type person.

   Diome replied that if it was so, then she wouldn't fit in anyways.

Editing

1.	(a) unpleasant	(c) to	(e) was
	(b) open	(d) write	(f) hands
2.	(a) address	(c) on	(e) finishing
	(b) French	(d) do	(f) You

Cloze Type

1. (a) at (b) to
   (c) on (d) in
   (e) with (f) and

2. (a) from (b) with
   (c) on (d) to
   (e) at (f) either

3. (a) when (b) of
   (c) an (d) on
   (e) the (f) who

4. (a) to (b) from
   (c) with (d) An
   (e) in (f) of

Phrasal Verbs

1.
   (a) put down
   (b) turned down
   (c) put aside
   (d) go about
   (e) went on

2.
   (a) called at
   (b) put on

(c) put across

(d) turn down

(e) get along

Completion of Dialogue

1.

(a) What do you want?

(b) Can you write it for me?

(c) Won't you?

(d) I can write it fast.

(e) Yes, I will do it for you

2.

(a) don't you?

(b) I won't give you this job.

(c) go back to your country

(d) Why did you come here for the job?

(e) It's okay. I shall leave now.

Vocabulary

1 (a) netizen (b) podcast

2 (a) for (b) yet

Guided/Creative Writing (6 Marks)

1. Malayalam superstar Mohanlal was honoured with the prestigious Dadasaheb Phalke award, India's highest cinematic recognition. The news caught nationwide attention and was widely reported in the newspapers. Write the likely **news report** based on the hints given.

   [Hints: Immense pride for Indian film industry — 71st National film award ceremony — by Droupadi Murmu – Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi — conferred for outstanding contribution to growth and development of Indian cinema (2023) - 2nd from Malayalam industry – major honours Padma bhushan (2019), Padma shri (2001) – 4 decades in Malayalam cinema — more than 400 films — titles "complete actor", "Lalettan"- concluded with "Cinema is the heartbeat of my soul"]

2. The world can be a better place only when man acknowledges his fellow beings and lives peacefully with each other. Don't you feel so based on the recent developments in the world around? Imagine you are asked to deliver a speech on the importance of universal brotherhood in the school assembly. Prepare the script of the **speech**.

   [Hints : Care for each other – mutual respect – love towards fellow beings – promote peace – forget differences – tolerance - secularism - work together for development – prioritise unity]

Information Transfer/ Interpretation of Data

A. Study the following table carefully and answer the questions that follow:

Asia Cup Tournament

Year	Winner	Runner-up	Host
2016	India	Bangladesh	Bangladesh
2018	India	Bangladesh	UAE
2022	Sri Lanka	Pakistan	Sri Lanka
2023	India	Sri Lanka	Sri Lanka & Pakistan
2025	India	Pakistan	UAE

1. Which team was defeated by India to lift the Asia Cup in 2016?
2. Which team was the runner-up in the year 2022?
   A) Sri Lanka
   B) Bangladesh
   C) UAE
   D) Pakistan
3. In which year did the two countries jointly host the Asia Cup Tournament?
4. Which country hosted Asia Cup Tournament in 2025?
5. How many times India consecutively defeated Bangladesh in the Asia Cup Tournament?
   A) Once
   B) Twice
   C) Thrice
   D) None of the above

B. Read the advertisement below and answer the questions that follow.

MY ASIANA

Malaysian flavours ***NOW OPEN***

My Asiana provides Malaysian flavours served with traditional staples of the east and the largest dessert menu and enviable selection of drinks.

Enjoy Malaysian delights and al fresco dining overlooking the waterfront of Bunga Bay.

Stylish and exciting, it brings a sea of fun for the whole family!

Lunch: 11.30 a.m. - 3.00 p.m.

Afternoon snack: 3.00 p.m.- 6.00 p.m.

Dinner: 6.00 p.m. -11.00 p.m.

For reservations: Fax: 07-2221829 | Call: 07-2216988

Shop > Play > Dine > Relax

>Water sports - Jet skiing, water skiing, kayaking, paddle boats, sail boats, knee boarding.

>Horseback riding> Ample free parking>Tram rides>Children's pool and picnic area>white sandy beach.

Bunga Bay

Jalan Skudai, 80200, Johor Bahru, Johor

1. Where is Bunga Bay located?
2. How can one facilitate their booking at My Asiana?
   A) Send a letter
   B) Send an e-mail
   C) Send a fax
   D) Send a notice

3. What is the highlight of the servings at the My Asiana?

4. Which among the following are the rides other than water sports?

   A) Horse Ride

   B) Picnic Area

   C) Bumper Cars

   D) Tram ride

Choose the correct option.

   i. A, B and C

   ii. A, C and D

   iii. A, B and D

   iv. All the above

5. Name any two water sports available at My Asiana?

Information Transfer/ Interpretation of Data

ANSWERS

A.

1. Bangladesh
2. D) Pakistan
3. 2023
4. UAE
5. B. Twice

B.

1. Johor
2. C. Send a fax
3. It provides Malaysian flavours with traditional staples of the East and the largest dessert menu.
4. (ii) A C &D
5. jet skiing, water skiing, kayaking, paddle boats, sail boats, knee boarding (any two)

Unfamiliar Passage

A. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow.

When Emma's family moved into the old Victorian house on Maple Street, she wasn't thrilled. It was far from her school, the paint was peeling, and the creaky stairs made strange noises at night. Still, something about the house felt mysterious, like it had a story to tell.

One rainy afternoon, while unpacking boxes in the attic, Emma stumbled upon a small wooden chest hidden beneath a dusty tarp. It had no lock, just an iron latch. Curious, she opened it. Inside was a bundle of yellowed letters tied with a red ribbon, and beneath them, a faded photograph of a young girl about Emma's age, standing in front of the same house.

The letters were dated over 100 years ago. They were written by a girl named Clara, who once lived in the house. In them, Clara described her life during the early 1900s—how she helped her mother bake bread, how she missed her father who was away at war, and how she dreamed of becoming a writer someday.

Emma felt a strange connection to Clara, as if their lives were somehow woven together by the house they both called home. She decided to write a story based on Clara's letters for her school's writing contest. When she won first place, Emma realized that the old house wasn't just full of creaks and dust—it was full of inspiration.

1. How did Emma feel about moving into the house first?

A) She was excited and curious.

B) She didn't like it very much.

C) She didn't care either way.

D) She wanted to move there herself.

Choose the correct option.

i. A B and C

ii. A and D

iii. Only B

iv. Only A

2. What did Emma find in the attic?

A) A locked box with jewellery.

B) A chest with old letters

C) A faded photograph of an old woman.

D) A faded photograph of a young girl.

Choose the correct option.

i. Only B and C

ii. Only A and B

iii. Only B and D

iv. All the above

3. What did Clara write about in her letters?

4. What did Emma do with the letters?

B. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow.

The power of a pen is enormously larger than a sword. What a sharp edged sword can't achieve can be achieved by the help of a minute tip of a pen. What it implies is that the power of writing is much stronger than the power of hatred, war, and fighting. A war always ends in killings and has only a single directional ending defeat, death, loss... There is no end of the tunnel when a war is there, and even if it comes, there is no light... Writing is priceless. Can we pay back for the stories told in our childhood - by parents, grandparents, teachers and elder siblings? Can we pay back for the stories read during our childhood from storybooks, comics etc. bought for a meagre cost but the impression of those stories, learning gained from those stories and the legacy that is carried from generation after generation... gives us a return that the amount paid for buying those books seems minuscule but the return is huge.

1. Why is it said that the power of pen is larger than the sword?

2. What are the brutal consequences of the war?

3. Who are the ones that make our childhood memorable with their stories?

   A) Parents, teachers and elder siblings.

   B) Parents, teachers and younger siblings.

   C) Grandparents, Parents and teachers.

   D) Grandparents, Parents and friends.

Choose the correct option.

   i. A and B

   ii. B and D

   iii. C and D

   iv. A and C

4. Pick out a word from the passage that means ‘very small’.

Unfamiliar Passage

ANSWERS

A.

1. (iii) Only B
2. (iv) Only B and D
3. Clara wrote about her life during the early 1900s and her dreams
4. Emma used the letters as an inspiration to write a story.

B.

1. The power of pen is larger than a sword because what a sharp-edged sword can't achieve can be achieved by the help of a minute tip of the pen.
2. A war always ends in killings, defeat, death and loss.
3. iv. A and C
4. minuscule

District Panchayath Kasaragod



District Institute of Education and Training (DIET)
Kasaragod